



Design a concept for a major event or function

D1.HCA.CL3.02

Trainee Manual



Design a concept for a major event or function

D1.HCA.CL3.02

Trainee Manual



William
Angliss
Institute

Specialist centre
for foods, tourism
& hospitality

Project Base

William Angliss Institute of TAFE
555 La Trobe Street
Melbourne 3000 Victoria
Telephone:
Facsimile:

(03) 9606 2111
(03) 9670 1330

Acknowledgements

Project Director:	Wayne Crosbie
Chief Writer:	Alan Hickman
Subject Writer:	Nick Hyland
Project Manager/Editor:	Alan Maguire
DTP/Production:	Daniel Chee, Mai Vu, Riny Yasin, Kaly Quach

The Association of Southeast Asian Nations (ASEAN) was established on 8 August 1967. The Member States of the Association are Brunei Darussalam, Cambodia, Indonesia, Lao PDR, Malaysia, Myanmar, Philippines, Singapore, Thailand and Viet Nam.

The ASEAN Secretariat is based in Jakarta, Indonesia.

General Information on ASEAN appears online at the ASEAN Website: www.asean.org.

All text is produced by William Angliss Institute of TAFE for the ASEAN Project on "Toolbox Development for Front Office, Food and Beverage Services and Food Production Divisions".

This publication is supported by the Australian Government's aid program through the ASEAN-Australia Development Cooperation Program Phase II (AADCP II).

Copyright: Association of Southeast Asian Nations (ASEAN) 2013.

All rights reserved.

Disclaimer

Every effort has been made to ensure that this publication is free from errors or omissions. However, you should conduct your own enquiries and seek professional advice before relying on any fact, statement or matter contained in this book. The ASEAN Secretariat and William Angliss Institute of TAFE are not responsible for any injury, loss or damage as a result of material included or omitted from this course. Information in this module is current at the time of publication. Time of publication is indicated in the date stamp at the bottom of each page.

Some images appearing in this resource have been purchased from stock photography suppliers Shutterstock and iStockphoto and other third party copyright owners and as such are non-transferable and non-exclusive. Clip arts, font images and illustrations used are from the Microsoft Office Clip Art and Media Library. Some images have been provided by and are the property of William Angliss Institute.

Additional images have been sourced from Flickr and SKC and are used under Creative Commons licence: <http://creativecommons.org/licenses/by/2.0/deed.en>

File name: TM_Design_a_concept_for_a_major_event_FN_020214



Table of contents

Introduction to trainee manual.....	1
Unit descriptor.....	3
Assessment matrix	5
Glossary	7
Element 1: Identify key objectives of event	9
Element 2: Establish concept, theme and format of event.....	35
Element 3: Prepare a concept plan	59
Presentation of written work.....	87
Recommended reading.....	89
Trainee evaluation sheet.....	91
Trainee Self-Assessment Checklist.....	93

Introduction to trainee manual

To the Trainee

Congratulations on joining this course. This Trainee Manual is one part of a 'toolbox' which is a resource provided to trainees, trainers and assessors to help you become competent in various areas of your work.

The 'toolbox' consists of three elements:

- A Trainee Manual for you to read and study at home or in class
- A Trainer Guide with Power Point slides to help your Trainer explain the content of the training material and provide class activities to help with practice
- An Assessment Manual which provides your Assessor with oral and written questions and other assessment tasks to establish whether or not you have achieved competency.

The first thing you may notice is that this training program and the information you find in the Trainee Manual seems different to the textbooks you have used previously. This is because the method of instruction and examination is different. The method used is called Competency based training (CBT) and Competency based assessment (CBA). CBT and CBA is the training and assessment system chosen by ASEAN (Association of South-East Asian Nations) to train people to work in the tourism and hospitality industry throughout all the ASEAN member states.

What is the CBT and CBA system and why has it been adopted by ASEAN?

CBT is a way of training that concentrates on what a worker can do or is required to do at work. The aim of the training is to enable trainees to perform tasks and duties at a standard expected by employers. CBT seeks to develop the skills, knowledge and attitudes (or recognise the ones the trainee already possesses) to achieve the required competency standard. ASEAN has adopted the CBT/CBA training system as it is able to produce the type of worker that industry is looking for and this therefore increases trainees' chances of obtaining employment.

CBA involves collecting evidence and making a judgement of the extent to which a worker can perform his/her duties at the required competency standard. Where a trainee can already demonstrate a degree of competency, either due to prior training or work experience, a process of 'Recognition of Prior Learning' (RPL) is available to trainees to recognise this. Please speak to your trainer about RPL if you think this applies to you.

What is a competency standard?

Competency standards are descriptions of the skills and knowledge required to perform a task or activity at the level of a required standard.

242 competency standards for the tourism and hospitality industries throughout the ASEAN region have been developed to cover all the knowledge, skills and attitudes required to work in the following occupational areas:

- Housekeeping
- Food Production
- Food and Beverage Service

- Front Office
- Travel Agencies
- Tour Operations.

All of these competency standards are available for you to look at. In fact you will find a summary of each one at the beginning of each Trainee Manual under the heading 'Unit Descriptor'. The unit descriptor describes the content of the unit you will be studying in the Trainee Manual and provides a table of contents which are divided up into 'Elements' and 'Performance Criteria'. An element is a description of one aspect of what has to be achieved in the workplace. The 'Performance Criteria' below each element details the level of performance that needs to be demonstrated to be declared competent.

There are other components of the competency standard:

- *Unit Title*: statement about what is to be done in the workplace
- *Unit Number*: unique number identifying the particular competency
- *Nominal hours*: number of classroom or practical hours usually needed to complete the competency. We call them 'nominal' hours because they can vary e.g. sometimes it will take an individual less time to complete a unit of competency because he/she has prior knowledge or work experience in that area.

The final heading you will see before you start reading the Trainee Manual is the 'Assessment Matrix'. Competency based assessment requires trainees to be assessed in at least 2 – 3 different ways, one of which must be practical. This section outlines three ways assessment can be carried out and includes work projects, written questions and oral questions. The matrix is designed to show you which performance criteria will be assessed and how they will be assessed. Your trainer and/or assessor may also use other assessment methods including 'Observation Checklist' and 'Third Party Statement'. An observation checklist is a way of recording how you perform at work and a third party statement is a statement by a supervisor or employer about the degree of competence they believe you have achieved. This can be based on observing your workplace performance, inspecting your work or gaining feedback from fellow workers.

Your trainer and/or assessor may use other methods to assess you such as:

- Journals
- Oral presentations
- Role plays
- Log books
- Group projects
- Practical demonstrations.

Remember your trainer is there to help you succeed and become competent. Please feel free to ask him or her for more explanation of what you have just read and of what is expected from you and best wishes for your future studies and future career in tourism and hospitality.

Unit descriptor

Design a concept for a major event or function

This unit deals with the skills and knowledge required to Design a concept for a major event or function in a range of settings within the hotel and travel industries workplace context.

Unit Code:

D1.HCA.CL3.02

Nominal Hours:

35 hours

Element 1: Identify key objectives of event

Performance Criteria

- 1.1 Clarify key objectives of event in consultation with customer/s and/or key stakeholders
- 1.2 Identify and analyse key information in consultation with customer/s and/or key stakeholders and other relevant parties
- 1.3 Identify and analyse factors which might impact on the event

Element 2: Establish concept, theme and format of event

Performance Criteria

- 2.1 Meet both customer needs and expectations in accordance with organisation standards, policies and procedures and within acceptable time frames
- 2.2 Develop an overall event concept, theme and format which reflects key objectives agreed upon with customer/s and/or key stakeholders
- 2.3 Verify practicality and viability of concept, theme and format through a sound process of consultation and analysis
- 2.4 Identify logistical requirements of overall concept, theme and format
- 2.5 Obtain relevant approval from customer/s and/or stakeholders prior to implementation

Element 3: Prepare a concept plan

Performance Criteria

- 3.1 Document theme and operational context of the event or function
- 3.2 Document elements of the total concept agreed to by customer/s and/or stakeholders
- 3.3 Gain written agreement from customer/s and/or stakeholders

Assessment matrix

Showing mapping of Performance Criteria against Work Projects, Written Questions and Oral Questions

The Assessment Matrix indicates three of the most common assessment activities your Assessor may use to assess your understanding of the content of this manual and your performance – Work Projects, Written Questions and Oral Questions. It also indicates where you can find the subject content related to these assessment activities in the Trainee Manual (i.e. under which element or performance criteria). As explained in the Introduction, however, the assessors are free to choose which assessment activities are most suitable to best capture evidence of competency as they deem appropriate for individual students.

		Work Projects	Written Questions	Oral Questions
Element 1: Identify key objectives of event				
1.1	Clarify key objectives of event in consultation with customer/s and/or key stakeholders	1.1	1,2	1
1.2	Identify and analyse key information in consultation with customer/s and/or key stakeholders and other relevant parties	1.2	3,4	2
1.3	Identify and analyse factors which might impact on the event	1.3	5,6	3
Element 2: Establish concept, theme and format of event				
2.1	Meet both customer needs and expectations in accordance with organisation standards, policies and procedures and within acceptable time frames	2.1	7,8	4
2.2	Develop an overall event concept, theme and format which reflects key objectives agreed upon with customer/s and/or key stakeholders	2.2	9,10	5
2.3	Verify practicality and viability of concept, theme and format through a sound process of consultation and analysis	2.3	11,12	6
2.4	Identify logistical requirements of overall concept, theme and format	2.4	13,14	7
2.5	Obtain relevant approval from customer/s and/or stakeholders prior to implementation	2.5	15,16	8

		Work Projects	Written Questions	Oral Questions
Element 3: Prepare a concept plan				
3.1	Document theme and operational context of the event or function	3.1	17,18	9
3.2	Document elements of the total concept agreed to by customer/s and/or stakeholders	3.2	19	10
3.3	Gain written agreement from customer/s and/or stakeholders	3.3	20	11

Glossary

Term	Explanation
Access	The right of entry to a venue
Accoutrements	'Accoutrements' are the items used to fit out the tables.
A la carte	Term used for a menu that has individually priced dishes
Banquet	A formal event comprising food, beverage and entertainment
Briefing	An informational meeting
Buffet	A display of food and beverage items
Catering	The provision of food, beverage and other services associated with an event, function or meeting
Client	The person who is arranging the event, either for themselves or on behalf of an organisation
Continental breakfast	A style of breakfast made up of fruit, cereal, pastries, juices and tea and coffee. No cooked food is normally included
Cover	A place setting for one guest
Crockery	Plates, bowls, cups and saucers
Cutlery	Knives, forks, spoons and teaspoons
Deficiencies	Problems that exist in an operation, technique or equipment
Event / Function	A structured purpose for people meeting together
Event Management Plan	A plan that takes into consideration all possible scenarios and activities that need to either be planned or addressed
Glassware	Different types of glass vessels
Infrastructure	Physical requirements needed to conduct an event
Liaise	To meet and communicate

Term	Explanation
Merchandise	Items that may be sold or given to event delegates
Quotation	A detailed presentation of proposed event activities and costs
Registration	The process of collecting and recording delegate information
Registrations correspondence	The various forms and documents that are sent to and from event management to delegates in the lead up to an event
Sponsor	An individual or company which makes a contribution to an event for an expected return
Suppliers	Different organisations that contribute to the running of an event or function

Element 1:

Identify key objectives of event

1.1 Clarify key objectives of event in consultation with customer/s and/or key stakeholders

Introduction



Events are a unique style of service provided by hospitality organisations. Whilst some aspects of the service reflect those provided in any food and beverage setting, such as the provision of food and beverage, there are many aspects to it that differ greatly. As most events are unique and present many challenges, it is an exciting operation that requires creative, flexible and hard working individuals.

This manual will explore the world of events and discuss all the activities associated in planning, preparing and delivering a concept for a major event of function.

Concept of events or functions

Traditionally, events were known as the provision of food and beverage or a meeting at a location which is not prepared at one's home. This normally meant in areas such as hotels, resorts, restaurants.

In today's world, events are not only restricted to these venues but can be expanded to include any location imaginable including:

- Homes for private functions
- Meetings, banquets, conventions, and weddings
- Nature areas including open water, zoos, parks, wineries
- Transportation vehicles – including planes, yachts, cars, buses
- Festivals
- Sporting events
- Birthday parties
- Anniversaries.



In today's world where time is of the essence, anyone can take advantage of organisations that provide events to organise any occasion, whether for business or pleasure. By using professional event organisers a lot of the organisation, hassle, responsibility and stress associated with holding an event are taken away.

Whilst some events do not involve catering, most will consist of some level of food and beverage provision. These items may be prepared completely at the event or organisers may choose to bring prepared items and put the finishing touches on once it arrives.

Again, the range of food and beverages provided can vary from a simple boxed meal consisting of a sandwich, fruit, cake and drink, through to lavish 10 course banquets, served at the table.

In most hotels there is a dedicated area for functions, which can cater to a wide variety of activities comprising each function.

The facilities normally comprise a number of empty rooms that can be used for a variety of purposes. In addition, they are designed with flexibility in mind to ensure that they meet the needs of each function. It is common for a function area to be made up of one large vacant area that can be divided into smaller individual rooms of different sizes.

Given that many function areas are extremely busy, it is also common for a wide range of hotel facilities to be used that are associated with functions.



Benefits of events or functions

There are many reasons why events are becoming a popular style of business.

For the customer:

- It saves time and stress
- It allows for professional staff to have the responsibility for running an event
- It provides access to rooms, space, locations and equipment that is not found in a normal office or home environment
- The outcome is a product or service which cannot be produced by a home or office environment

For a hospitality organisation

- It is an additional revenue source
- It allows the organisation to promote itself away from the physical location of the hotel
- It promotes creativity, skills and knowledge in staff.

Types of events or functions

Before we explore the objectives of a function or event, it is important to explore the different types of events or functions that exist.

Most people may think that a function is just a catered event where people sit down to a banquet dinner. It could not be further from the truth.

There are endless styles of functions that can be arranged, tailored to the unique specifications and requirements of the customer.

Therefore the activities to be conducted will vary depending on the event of function that is taking place.



Styles of functions

The hospitality industry can deliver a range of different function styles for customers including:

- Breakfasts
- Lunches
- Dinners
- Seminars, workshops and conferences
- Cocktail parties
- General parties – birthdays, celebrations of various sorts
- Weddings/receptions
- Anniversaries
- 21st birthday parties
- Product launches and distributor functions
- School formal, annual dinners and dinner dances
- Annual general meetings
- Training seminars
- Graduations and award nights
- Press receptions
- Fashion shows
- Special events
- Tradeshows
- Stage productions, including music events.



As you can see, the styles of functions are endless. Whilst many hospitality organisations may offer all of these to potential customers, they may also specialise in order to attract a select or niche market and be seen as the industry leaders for a particular style of function.

MICE

Many venues focus on the MICE sector of the industry.

MICE stands for Meetings, Incentives, Conferences and Events.

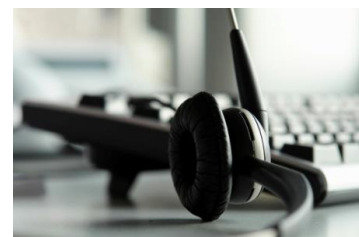
- Meetings include general business meetings
- Incentives refers to functions that businesses organise to reward or motivate staff
- Conferences are usually business/industry based occasions where people get together to discuss issues and share knowledge
- Events can include bands, concerts and a variety of entertainments.



Range of event and function facilities

The various hotel facilities that may be used to directly or indirectly support functions include:

- Meeting/conference room. This is the main facility that is used for a function. Many functions during the day hold business related meetings. The focus of these rooms is to ensure small to large meetings can be conducted with the appropriate technological capacity
- Stand up conference areas. This can include areas outside the main conference room used for welcoming customers, break out areas, cocktail receptions etc. These areas may not be as large as the main room themselves. However they may offer great views and are a great area to use, when the main conference room needs to be replenished or cleaned
- Banquet room. These rooms, often similar to meeting or conference rooms, are used for banquets. As will be discussed in the next section, a banquet is a function based around the provision of food and beverage. Therefore, not only does the room need to be large enough to accommodate weddings, but it needs direct access to a kitchen or bar dispensing facility
- Exhibition bays and space. Many hotels cater to the exhibition market where customers can showcase their offerings. These rooms need to be big and are able to accommodate separate bays and high displays
- Business centres. These are used to aid organisers and participants of events with all their business needs through a host of services including:
 - High-speed Internet access
 - Word processing
 - Photocopying
 - Faxing services
 - Computer access and rental
 - Faxing services
 - Office supplies
 - Packaging and shipping
 - Secretarial services
 - Courier service
 - Translations
 - Arrangement of transport
- Auditoriums – used for large audience presentations and events. These areas must be able to accommodate large seating capacities and adequate height and depth for main stages etc.



- Press rooms. These are used by the press in order to prepare and submit information relating to a function taking place in the hotel. They will normally include the provision of:
 - Tables and Chairs
 - Internet access
 - Business equipment
 - Basic food and beverage
- Storage bays. These are used to store a wide range of items used for a function, whether for the use of staff or customers and include:
 - Storage cupboards for packages, boxes, equipment, stationery, documents decorations and displays to be used in a function. Often these items are sent in advance of the function itself by the organiser
 - Cloak rooms for jackets and coats of participants
 - Baggage areas for luggage of participants. In some cases participants of functions may not have access to accommodation rooms and need a place to store luggage whilst the function commences. In addition presents for weddings may need to be stored for later collection
- Parking facilities. Naturally, depending on the size of the function, suitable parking needs to be arranged. Spaces may need to be reserved for all participants or for a selected few VIPs
- Change rooms may need to be provided for sporting events or where participants may need to refresh after a conference before departing the hotel
- Display areas. These may be outside the main function room enabling a company to place a banner or a display. Often it is immediately outside the main function room, the lift or in the lobby of the hotel
- Designated and discreet sections of restaurants and/or bars which are normally used as dedicated lunch or dining areas for functions. In cases where main function rooms are operating at maximum capacity, these may be used as function rooms themselves. They will be partitioned off to ensure privacy. Quite often they are used for staff meetings and training sessions
- Food and beverage service. Many functions have some element of food and beverage which require preparation kitchens, fridges etc.
- Accommodation. Accommodation rooms may be used for a number of reasons including:
 - Accommodate participants overnight
 - To be used as breakout rooms to host smaller meetings
 - To be used as a rest and change area for wedding parties and for VIPs at conferences. It is not uncommon for a hotel to allocate a number of rooms to a large function enabling VIPs to refresh before departing for long flights etc.



- Sound and lighting. Not only does sound and equipment take up a large amount of space, any parts must also be stored in a safe and secure location
- Communication technologies and equipment. In most events or functions, there is a need for technical equipment or services including:
 - Audio – including taping, telephone hook-ups, speakers to external points
 - Visual – video, television, direct conference
 - Data projectors
 - Large screens including printable white boards
 - Multi-media provision including linkages and compatible hook-up points
 - Computers and internet connectivity
- Sound and music facilities, including microphones, speakers etc.
- Gardens – often used for outdoor events such as cocktail parties and weddings.



Receiving an enquiry

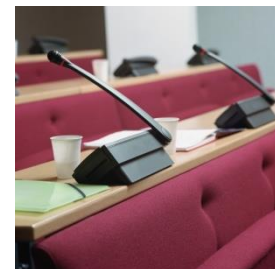
In many cases, the client will contact a hotel events department directly, either by phone or by email in relation to an event enquiry.

In many cases the client will be contacting a number of possible venues not only to see what is available but to compare offerings and prices to ensure they get a provider who can best cater to their needs.

When receiving an enquiry an event co-ordinator may take some summary information to help them prepare a detailed quotation for their review.

Some of this information can include:

- Contact person – correct name, name of business
- Contact details – phone number, email address etc.
- Type of event
- Location
- Date and time of event
- Budget
- Possible number of attendees or guests
- Overview of event requirements
- Special instructions or requests.



As events can be quite complex, in an initial discussion it is often the goal to get an overview of the client's expectations and to prepare a proposal based on these.

Normally the event co-ordinator will also extend an invitation for the client to visit the hotel to discuss the event in more detail and to show them in person what the hotel or establishment can provide.

Meeting with clients to clarify objectives

To date, we have looked at a number of possible events that may be required by the client. However, before any event or function can be organised there is a need to determine client needs for it.

The most effective way to do this is to meet face-to-face with the client and talk to them about their needs, wants and preferences.

After receiving an enquiry and once initial information has been sent to clients regarding an event or function it is best practice to invite the client to your venue to:

- Talk to them about their expectations and needs
- Allow them to view the property and its facilities
- Meet some of the key staff, where appropriate.



The meeting should be scheduled at a time to suit the client and conducted in a private location, such as the board room or your office.

It is appropriate to provide catering, light refreshments and even a meal.

In the following sections, the information gathered in relation to an event will be detailed.

Types of event or function objectives

General objectives

There are many overall objectives for holding an event, some of which include:

- Increased revenue and profit to a department
- Increased brand awareness in the market place
- Expanding the range of products or services provided by an organisation
- Promoting new products or services
- Reinforcing or cementing success of organisation.

Specific objectives

Each event will also have objectives which they would like to achieve, many of which are service related and aimed at meeting set standards. Some of these include:

- Run a safe and secure event with no accidents
- Ensure the client is satisfied
- Ensure sponsors are satisfied with their investment and that their objectives were achieved
- Ensure all delegates who attend the event are satisfied
- Ensure the desired profit margins are obtained
- Ensure the event has no or minimal environmental impact
- Ensure service standards reflect overall organisational standards.



Need to communicate with stakeholders

Communication throughout the planning, preparation and delivery of an event is vital to ensure that all stakeholders are not only aware of what they need to do, but also how it interrelates or impacts other stakeholders.

All successful functions are a result of effective teamwork.

This highlights the need to involve others in the planning phase so that the implementation works as required.

It is vital you appreciate the need to proactively include others in the planning stage, especially those who will be participating in the preparation and execution of the function.

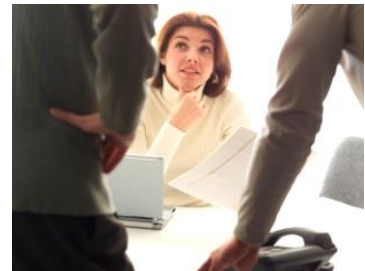
Never be afraid of asking for input from people in relation to planning these occasions.

Identification of key stakeholders

There may be many stakeholders who are involved in the organisation and implementation of an event.

These may include:

- Event principal
- Local community
- Organising committees
- Local authorities including police and fire
- Internal event staff
- External contractors
- Entertainers
- Talent
- Staff from host businesses.



Event liaison and management structure

Every event must have clear channels of communication and lines of authority and responsibility. In the event of large events, involving a number of suppliers, host businesses, departments or staff, this is essential to ensure that all key decision makers are not only aware of what is happening but have given appropriate consent or authorisation to do so.

It is vital to confirm:

- Event liaison – who are the contact people communications need to be directed to and who needs to be copied or involved in communication
- Management structure – who are the key managers in relation to different aspects of an event
- Lines of authority – who are the ultimate decision makers or who have overriding authority and responsibility.



1.2 Identify and analyse key information in consultation with customer/s and/or key stakeholders and other relevant parties

Introduction

As identified in the previous section it is important to identify client requirements in order to determine whether or not the venue can, or wants to, provide what is required.

The following is a list of the topics that need to be addressed as part of this process. Your venue may have a checklist prepared to guide you through the questions to ask and the information to be gathered at this initial meeting. Where you have such a checklist you must use it.

If you do not have such a checklist it is vital you take extensive notes to function as the basis for the work you will need to do in order to provide costings, suggestions, options and ideas to the client.

Timing

As mentioned, this is probably the first thing to be discussed.

You need to identify the date the client wants their function and the time of day their function will occupy.

Most clients will have a specific date in mind and a start and finish time. In the majority of cases this is not negotiable. If you are already booked for this date the client will often have to look elsewhere. In some limited cases the client will have room to move the function.

You need to identify:

- Date of the event or function. Remember some functions such as conferences and incentives will take more than one day
- The amount of preparation time needed to set up rooms and otherwise get the function area ready for the event. This may include use of in-house staff and external suppliers to set up stages, lighting and displays
- Checking availability in Functions Booking book
- Assessing the potential for moving existing bookings to a different location, room and/or date.



Most venues have a function booking book in paper-based or electronic format. You should have this with you at the meeting to assist in identifying availability and options.

Note that further details regarding timing requirements will need to be addressed at a later stage when the function is confirmed.

Type of event or function

You need to identify the type of function the client wants to hold.

This is important as some venues have a policy of not hosting certain events such as rowdy parties or sporting groups.

You also need to know how the type of function intersects with other room availability. For example, you may be able to host a small function for 20 people in a small function room at the same time as a larger function is taking place in the main function room.



Size and type of room

One of the most important aspects of a function is the requirement for where the function is to take place and how much room is needed.

Questions that may be asked include:

- What room requirements do they need?
- Do they have a preference for your ballroom, dining room, foyer, outside area, small conference room or theatre?
- Is there a need for break-out rooms?



Numbers attending

This is another critical requirement as all venues have limits on the numbers of people they can accommodate.

Once again, this factor also intersects with potential room availability.

Some venues will also seek to identify the ratio of males to females attending, as well as the number of children. In a conference situation there may also be accompanying delegates not attending the conference.



Catering

At this stage discussions regarding catering need only to address general requirements.

Catering refers to the provision of food and beverages for the function.

You should attempt to determine answers to the following questions:

- If the enquiry is about a function:
 - Is catering required 'on arrival'? If so, what is required?
 - Does the client want a sit-down meal or stand-up finger food?



- If it is a sit-down meal, how many courses?
- If it is finger food, what sort of food is required?
- Are there any special requests, or needs to accommodate any special health or cultural requirements?
- If the enquiry is about an event:
 - Is catering required 'on arrival'? If so, what is required?
 - Is there a requirement to provide catering at break times – morning tea, afternoon tea, supper? If so, what is required? Danish pastries, cake, biscuits, fruit?
 - Is there any requirement to provide refreshments throughout the day for the event? This may include mints, bottled water, jugs of water, fruit juices etc.
 - Is catering required for breakfast, lunch or dinner?
 - Does the client want a sit-down meal or stand-up finger food for lunch?
 - If it is a sit-down meal, how many courses?
 - If it is finger food, what sort of food is required?
 - Are there any special requests, or needs to accommodate any special health or cultural requirements?



Technical equipment

The technical requirements for a function will vary greatly depending on the type and style of function being booked.

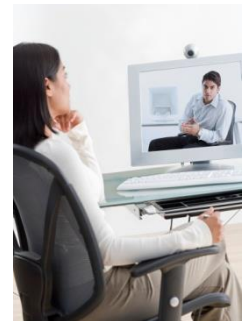
Not all establishments will have technical equipment on-hand and may need to lease or hire such equipment from an outside service.

The cost of such will be charged to the customer.

The different types of technical equipment were previously discussed.

Some clients, especially companies, will want to use their own audio-visual people and equipment for the screening of DVDs, PowerPoint presentations slides, the presentation of speeches, recording of events, or management of teleconferences.

It is important to get a clear understanding of what is required in this regard as your costings will need to include the cost of any equipment that has to be hired or bought-in for the function.



Themes and decorations

It is quite common for functions to involve a theme and the use of decorations to match the theme or to add to the visual appeal of the event.



From time to time you may be asked to suggest a theme for a function, and to suggest decorations.

It is best to ask the client if they have any thoughts on the matter before making these suggestions as they are fraught with danger since the client may not agree with all your recommendations.

Where possible refer the client to photographs or DVDs of previous functions.

Questions that may be asked include:

- Is there to be a theme or any decorations required?
- Is the client supplying them and putting them up?
- Does the client want the venue to supply them?
- What sort do they want and how extensive are they?



Security

You should also ask the client about their requirements for security.

While the venue may provide a basic security service for small functions, larger functions can create a need for extra security staff, which will have to be charged for.

Security staff may, depending on the function, be required to:

- Provide screening of people entering the function
- Provide general crowd control
- Secure car parks
- Patrol the areas 'out-of-hours' – this is most common where displays, marquees etc., are set up in external areas.

Use of external suppliers

There are a wide variety of external suppliers that can be used to help provide or assist in the running and co-ordination of an event.

The range of external providers that can be used will be explained later in this manual.

Style and format

Functions may range from informal through to formal to reflect the nature of the function.

Informal functions

Informal functions are characterised by:

- No set time for guest arrival
- No dress code
- Flexible times for food and beverage service
- Impromptu speeches
- No service protocol
- No seating plan.



Formal functions

Formal functions are characterised by:

- Dress code
- Set time for guests to arrive
- Registration and name tag requirements
- Allocated time for speeches and presentations etc.
- Specific meal times
- Semi-silver service or full silver service
- Program for the occasion
- Specific service protocols
- Specific seating plan
- Guest speakers or Master of Ceremonies presentation
- Specific times for entertainment to commence and finish.



Room layout

Room layout will depend on customer needs and the style best suited to meet those needs.

Stand-up function

This style of function is generally used for cocktail parties, general parties or lunches that are part of a conference.

The only seating might be around the edges of the room with several tables placed randomly in various places to provide the guests with a place to put down their drinks and any unwanted glassware, plates, food scraps.

When deciding if a stand-up function is suitable, it is worth bearing in mind the proposed duration of the function. Does the client think that the guests can stand for the length of time expected?

Stand-up lunches for conferences where delegates have been seated all morning are a good idea to allow them to stand up for a while.

Stand-up lunches are usually a less expensive than sit-down meals and they encourage people to mingle and network.

The very nature of a stand-up function is attractive to some clients and to some function types as it does not encourage people to settle in and stay for extended periods.

Sit down function

This style of function is generally used for weddings or formal dinners, banquets and presentations.

Most dinners for conferences are also sit-down.

The tables and seating used for such a function are placed in accordance with specific table number and stated seating requirements.

Some functions may require tables of six, whereas other functions may require tables of ten or more.



Boardroom meeting

Smaller functions or meetings can be catered for in small rooms or the board room.

There are a number of styles to use when setting up a boardroom meeting.

Each style has its own benefits, which should be matched to the needs of the client.

- **Theatre style.** This is where chairs are placed in rows facing a stage or head table. This layout is used to address large audiences who do not need tables in which to record information. It is also used where the audience is required to listen as opposed to communicating themselves. It is important to have aisles in which both participants and speakers can easily move around in. It is popular with seminars and presentations
- **Boardroom style.** This is the use of a small to large table where all participants are able to see and converse with each other and have their own place in which to spread out documents and record information. This layout is popular for many meetings as it allows for interaction
- **Hollow square.** Depending on the size of the audience, a boardroom format may be required, to allow for interaction and discussion but there are simply too many people. In essence this is where tables are set up in a square, hexagon or round format with room for microphones, photographers or plant displays etc. in the middle
- **Classroom style.** This is where tables and chairs are set up in straight lines or in a V-shape formation, similar to a classroom setting at school. The tables face the front of the room so that all participants can easily see the instructor. This layout is popular when large amounts of audience members are in attendance, each requiring space to layout documents. It is also useful in presenting computer training sessions
- **Banquet style.** This is where smaller round, square or rectangular tables are used for smaller discussions and group work
- **U Shape.** Also known as a 'horseshoe' this format allows audience members to see each other and interact whilst accommodating larger numbers. It also allows for a presenter to walk within the 'U-shape' itself to personally interact with each participant. It is a very popular layout method
- **E-shape.** This is a variation to a U 'shape' as it allows for greater numbers of audience members, as a table is placed in the middle of the U 'shape'.



Using different set up options

Depending on the function they may use different layouts either:

- Simultaneously – where a function may address large audiences, therefore requiring a seminar format, but then allows participants to work in smaller groups, therefore using a boardroom or banquet style
- At different times of the day – for example a room may be set up for a conference using a U-shape format during the day but needs a banquet layout at night for a formal dinner.

Develop options and ideas in consultation with colleagues and suppliers to assist client with event planning

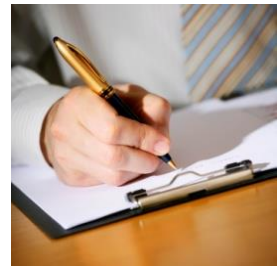
Some clients have extensive experience with planning an event and many do not. Some clients will expect you to assist them in developing and planning their event and others will not.

How do you identify if the client needs planning assistance?

You will gain a good idea of whether or not the client needs this type of assistance during the initial meeting with them.

You will form your judgement by virtue of:

- The questions they ask
- What they know about the venue and functions in general
- Any previous experience with functions they share with you
- Whether or not they are repeat clients.



If you are unsure about whether or not they require help it is acceptable to ask them if they do.

Remaining client focussed

When you are developing ideas and options to assist the client in the development and planning of their function it is vital to remain client focussed.

It is essential the client believes your advice, suggestions, recommendations etc. are being made to best meet their stated needs and preferences. It is very counter-productive for the client to believe they are being offered options and ideas which are solely of benefit to the venue by virtue of adding cost to the final bill.

Events and functions demand the client trusts and has confidence in the venue. As soon as the client starts thinking your focus is on 'money' (maximising revenue, optimising profit) and not on their needs, this trust and confidence quickly starts to evaporate.

Who may be involved in this process?

The type and extent of the function will determine who you should involve.

Obviously not every venue will have all of the following people, but the following list is indicative of who you might talk to:

- Property owner or manager
- Head Chef
- Food and Beverage manager

- Bar manager
- Dining room manager
- Head housekeeper
- Entertainment/event manager
- Functions manager
- Head of Security.



Arrange or communicate with external providers

Because all functions are unique they demand attention be paid to identifying and organising necessary resource requirements for every function or event.

While the venue will have certain physical facilities available as standard, individual functions traditionally may require the use of specialised skills or equipment which may not be available within the organisation.

At these times, external services will be utilised.

Given the nature of the function department, function managers will have strong working relationships with a number of external suppliers to help meet the requests of clients.

Types of external providers

Many functions will require you to use the services of third party, external businesses to source items and services needed to ensure the successful running of a function.

These external suppliers can vary enormously depending on the type and scale of the function and may include:

- Florists
- Photographers
- Party Hire companies – for trestles, extra crockery, cutlery, glassware, chair covers, seating, decorations
- Entertainers – bands, disc jockeys, solo performers etc.
- Suppliers of rental technical equipment for audio and visual needs
- Printers – for personalised stationary, menus, signage and decoration needs
- Security agencies – for extra security staff
- Employment agencies – for additional waiting, bar, service and cooking staff
- Business support services – such as interpreters, translators, secretarial support
- Transportation – including chauffeurs, limousines, private cars or buses for tours
- Clowns and animals.



Arranging external services

When developing relationships with external providers, there are a number of steps that may be taken including:

Sourcing option

Like with any business, different companies will offer different products and services as a means of identifying their point of difference. Even in similar businesses, such as equipment, linen or theming hire companies, the actual products they provide will differ.

It is a good idea to source at least three companies in a similar field to ensure that you have an understanding of a wide selection of what is available.

Liaising with providers to identify and cost necessary items and services

Given that a hotel's relationship with external suppliers will not be a one-off event, it is important to gain an understanding of what an external provider can provide including:

- Range of offering – selection of products and services
- Pricing structure for each item – including discounts or complimentary additional items
- Service guarantees – what quality and quantity guarantees can they provide
- Availability - how available are items. It is no use choosing a provider, no matter how cheap, if their items are never available
- Prep-event services – delivery and setting up arrangements
- Event services – what will the company do during the event to ensure its products or services operate as expected
- Post-event services – take down and removal of items, cleaning etc.
- Billing and payment arrangements.

In the eyes of the customer, what is provided at an event, regardless of whether internally or externally provided, will impact on the reputation of the hotel, therefore it is essential that external providers are carefully selected.

Facilitating access by external providers to venue to enable on-site assessment of requirements, facilities and demands

Most external providers will need access to a venue before the commencement time of an event to set up. Likewise after the completion of a function, they will also need time to take down. remove and clean the area.

It is essential that providers understand:

- What time they have access
- Delivery and parking zones
- Storage areas
- Commencement and finishing times of the function
- Amount of time allocated after the event for access.

Connecting service providers with customer, where appropriate

In many cases functions staff will suggest that external providers correspond directly with the client because:

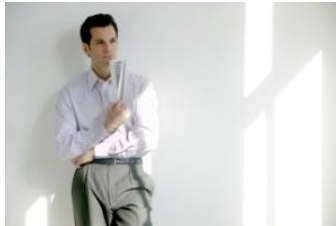
- Functions staff do not have the technical knowledge or understanding of what the external provider can offer
- External providers can explain what they can offer and provide suggestions
- Can remove a level of activity or responsibility from the functions department.



1.3 Identify and analyse factors which might impact on the event

Introduction

In the previous section, we have seen there is a quite an amount of information that needs to be clarified in terms of what the client requires for a function or event.



Whilst most of the requirements and needs of a client can be addressed without any influence or impact from other internal or external factors, like with the organisation of any key activity within an organisation, there may be some factors that need to be identified and analysed to determine how they will impact on the ability to hold or successfully conduct any part of an event.

This section will explore some of the factors that can impact on the running of an event or function.

Resource availability

The usage of resources are important activities in any business, especially when conducting events or functions.

The organisation needs to have the resources it needs to successfully run the event or parts of it, ensuring that money is not wasted on resources that are not necessary or inappropriate to the task.

Resources can encompass:

- Physical resources
- Human resources
- Financial resources
- Intellectual property.

While the exact nature, type and quantity of resources required by an organisation will vary depending on the event or function being held, common resources requirements include

- Location/premises
- Occupational health and safety (OH&S) resources
- Equipment
- Raw materials – used to produce the products or service
- Stock and supplies – used to support the operation of the event
- Technical equipment and software
- Staffing.



Potential for attracting additional resources

As can be seen in the last section, there are many resources that are required to conduct an event or function.

Whilst in many cases, one hospitality establishment may be able to host all aspects of the overall function, at times additional resources may be sought from different sources. This is especially true when conducting large or specialised events.

These sources of additional resources may come from:

- Co-hosting
- Sponsorship.

Both of these sources will be explored in more detail.

Co-hosting

It is not uncommon for a hospitality organisation to reach out to other companies to help host an event or provide aspects of it.

These other businesses can include, but are certainly not limited to:

Hotels

This is a common source of additional resources including:

- Staff – especially where large amounts of people are needed for a short duration of time
- Accommodation – additional hotel rooms may be required to accommodate large volumes of event participants
- Equipment – this can include a range of equipment including tables, chairs, kitchen equipment etc.
- Function rooms – one hotel may have a shortage of 'breakout' or meeting rooms. In addition hotels will have a specific maximum of persons who can be accommodated in one large space, such as a ballroom. If a special dinner or function is to be conducted as part of a larger event, hotels with larger rooms may be required to host it.

If individual hotels are part of a chain, it is not uncommon for hotels to help each other as it:

- Ensures the 'hotel chain' can secure large functions that cannot be hosted by competing properties
- Ensures properties within the same chain are not competing with each other
- Helps increase brand exposure and revenue for more than one property
- Improves the efficiency of staff and resource utilisation.

Recruitment agencies

Naturally when holding large functions, the need for additional staff for short periods of time is common. Besides recruiting staff or drawing staff from other properties within a chain, the easiest way of getting staff at short notice is through the use of recruitment agencies.



Suppliers

In events where a specific skill set or theme plays a key role, it is quite common to involve suppliers in the hosting of events. This can include, but is not limited to:

- Wine companies – for food and wine festivals
- Equipment suppliers – for trade or IT fairs.

Exhibition Centres

These venues may be called upon when large exhibition venues are required.

Government agencies and industry associations

Where an event is aimed at promoting or attracting investment into an area or industry, quite often there will be a government or private agency or association who may have a vested interest in co-hosting an event.

Some examples include:

- Local investment boards investing in trade shows showcasing local capacity
- Local government investing in tourism focused events.

Sponsorship

Sponsorship is a common part of running an event. There are benefits for both the event organiser and the sponsoring business and it has been proven on many occasions that event sponsorship is a perfect match and essential partnership when hosting events, of any type, in any location and of any size.

Benefits for sponsors

Naturally, if a person or company is going to 'invest' in an event, they will seek some type of benefit in return. These benefits can include, but are certainly not limited to:

- Right to display and promote their name at the event itself and on any materials related to the event
- Increased brand awareness
- Affiliation with other organisations, charities or celebrities who may be in attendance
- Enhancing the brand or visibility of an event by having a 'reputable' company behind it
- Engaging with the community and employees
- Enhancing product and service sampling amongst its desired audience
- Improving contact and visual presence with the media



Considerations when planning sponsorship

There are a number of considerations that should be taken into account when planning and implementing sponsorship activities:

- Try to secure a new sponsor each year whilst maintaining repeat sponsors
- Sponsorships must be identified as part of the initial planning phase
- Brainstorm program elements early to enhance creativity
- Try to involve potential sponsors when deciding sponsorship benefits or inclusions
- Allow maximum time to secure sponsors

- Identify the value of each category; reinforce the benefits of a previously held program and its sponsorship levels
- Create a fact sheet for each property or individual sponsorship category
- Offer higher level sponsors the right of first refusal. The majority of sponsors are either participating or on site
- Renew all sponsorships at least six months prior to the event
- Secure new or replacement sponsors at least three months prior to the event
- Hold weekly or regular meetings to communicate sponsor status and renewals.

Identify potential sponsors

Whilst the range of sponsors is endless, sponsorship is normally offered to organisations that are like minded or will find some benefit in being involved in an event.

Potential sponsors can include:

- Various individuals
- Government agencies – local government agencies, departments of trade etc. commonly engage in events where organisations, products and services from their particular region are represented
- Companies – from a wide variety of industries trying to appeal to the target audience
- Industry organisations – this may be other hotel groups, food, beverage or equipment suppliers
- Community groups – including project focused groups, schools and volunteer organisations.

A great starting point is to compile a list of suitable sponsors. This can include:

- Current vendors
- Past sponsors
- Business partners
- Affiliated businesses.

The key is to identify possible benefits participation in an event may have and then identify companies that may be suited to the benefits being provided.

Types of sponsorship

In summary sponsorship normally is designed to account for 20-30% of event costs, with the remaining costs either being borne by the organising company or through delegate packages or entry costs.

There are a number of common types of sponsorship including:

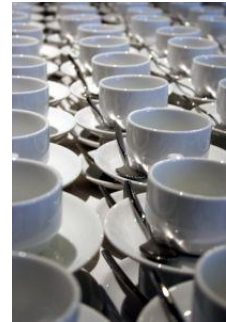
- Cash sponsorship – where sponsors provide a financial contribution
- Product sponsorship – where sponsors donate actual products and services for limited or no charge. This can also include products and samples in gift bags
- Venue sponsorship – where sponsors will provide a venue for the use of an event
- Person sponsorship – where a key person, celebrity or staff member donates time to an event.

Lead time restrictions

Whilst many events are arranged well in advance, this is not always the case. Whilst weddings will not be booked the week before it is due to take place, it is quite common for large meetings to be arranged with short notice.

Considerations when deciding to hold events with short notice include its ability to:

- Provide sufficient amounts of meeting or event rooms
- Provide sufficient amounts of accommodation rooms
- Arrange staff to coordinate the event
- Source sufficient food and beverage supplies
- Source other resources.



Potential levels of participation and interest

Whilst an establishment may have the resources to host an event, two of the key factors that will be considered are:

- Its ability to generate sufficient participation and interest
- Its ability to generate sufficient profit.

If it appears an event will not be well patronaged, there is no point for a hospitality establishment to allocate time, energy and resources towards it.



Competitive environment

Like in any industry, a hospitality establishment will be competing for business with other hotels, accommodation providers and possible event organisations.

Given that each of these competitors will be trying to promote their 'unique point of difference' at times a hotel may not actively seek an event if:

- Their venue is not appropriate
- If a competitor is better suited to host the event
- If a competitor is offering prices that do not provide suitable profit.



Timing and duration factors

Each organisation has limited resources which must be allocated and managed wisely in an effort to generate the greatest profits possible.

The concept of yield management is not unique to hotels. It is about selling a perishable product, such as function or event spaces, at the right price that reflects the demand conditions at that time, in order to maximise profits.



In order to attract the highest possible financial return they must consider:

When best to sell event space for different types of functions. For example, in periods of high demand a hotel will not sell a possible event space for 'room hire only'. They will want to generate additional revenues as well from that space including equipment hire and food and beverage services.

Considerations on demand may include, but are not limited to:

- Traditional peak periods
- Public holidays
- Other public events.

Talent requirements

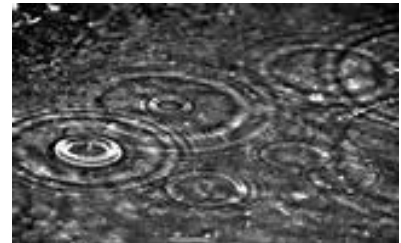
In order to successfully hold events an establishment must not only have the right amount of staff but also ensure the staff selected have the necessary knowledge and skills to undertake the roles and functions expected of them.

This knowledge and skill set may relate to:

- Knowledge of the client and their needs
- Cookery knowledge and skills
- Service knowledge and skills
- Product knowledge
- Audio visual and IT skill sets.

Climate

This relates to weather. Whilst weather may not affect many corporate seminars and meetings it will certainly impact outdoor events, such as weddings, festivals or sporting events.



Access

It is important to identify what the client requirements are likely to be prior to the event in terms of access.

Many clients require access to the venue or function area to deliver materials, goods, and displays and to enable their personnel to assist with setting up displays, setting sound and lighting levels, testing equipment, placing flowers on tables etc.

In some cases their needs can be quite extensive and in other cases there is no need for access other than at the time of the function.

This topic relates strongly to bump-in and bump-out.

When you discuss access it is useful to also cover a description of what the client wants to bring in to the venue. For example, the client may want to have a car as part of a display but your facility may not enable access to something of that size.

Bump-in and bump-out

Bump-in and bump-out is commonly just called 'bump-in, bump-out'.

It is most commonly used when bands are involved but can also apply to other events.

It refers to the time and dates that the client has to move their items into the venue (bump-in) and for removing them from the venue after the event has finished (bump-out).

It is important client requirements in this regard are factored in when determining availability of the venue.

Generally, the larger the function, the more time required for bump-in, bump-out. One to two days is not uncommon.

You also need to realise the bump-in, bump out times can also add expense to the costing as there will need to be someone from the venue available to answer questions, provide directions and oversee activities during these periods.



Marketing and promotional issues

Marketing and promotional efforts

One key factor when determining whether to host an event comes down to marketing and promotional effects.

This includes:

- How much effort is required to promote the event
- The message that is to be communicated
- If the event or promotion reflects and is in line with the establishment's overall brand image.



Media coverage

Some hospitality organisations will not take on events that may appear to be controversial or may tarnish the image of the establishment.

It is also important to remember that other events being hosted at the same time may be impacted upon. Their needs also need to be considered.

Media and the client

It is always worthwhile raising the issue of media attention at any function and identifying how the client wants them treated.

Clients often forget about media attendance.

In many cases the client can require them to receive specified catering, access etc.



Work Projects

It is a requirement of this Unit that you complete Work Projects as advised by your Trainer. You must submit documentation, suitable evidence or other relevant proof of completion of the project to your Trainer by the agreed date.

- 1.1 To fulfil the requirements of this Work Project you are asked to think of yourself as a client of an event which you would like to organise and:
 - Provide a summary of the event
 - Identify the objectives for the event
 - Prepare a list of requirements you would have in relation to that event including:
 - Facilities
 - Location
 - Catering
 - Equipment
 - Themes and decorations
 - Use of external suppliers
 - Room layout.
- 1.2 To fulfil the requirements of this Work Project you are asked to think of yourself as the event co-ordinator and identify:
 - Sources of external suppliers which may be used to meet the above mentioned needs. Provide examples of actual companies in your region who can provide services as required
 - Possible co-hosting arrangements including the types of assistance each organisation can help
 - Sponsorship opportunities including examples of companies and types of sponsorship.
- 1.3 To fulfil the requirements of this Work Project you are asked to research and identify factors that could impact on the above mentioned event including possible solutions to any foreseeable problems.

Summary

Identify key objectives of event

Clarify key objectives of event in consultation with customer/s and/or key stakeholders

- Concept of events or functions
- Benefits of events or functions
- Types of events or functions
- Range of event and function facilities
- Receiving an enquiry
- Meeting with clients to clarify objectives
- Types of event or function objectives
- Need to communicate with stakeholders
- Identification of key stakeholders
- Event liaison and management structure.

Identify and analyse key information in consultation with customer/s and/or key stakeholders and other relevant parties

- Timing
- Type of event or function
- Size and type of room
- Numbers attending
- Catering
- Technical equipment
- Themes and decorations
- Security
- Use of external suppliers
- Style and format
- Room layout
- Using different set up options
- Develop options and ideas in consultation with colleagues and suppliers to assist client with event planning
- Arrange or communicate with external providers.

Identify and analyse factors which might impact on the event

- Resource availability
- Potential for attracting additional resources
- Lead time restrictions
- Potential levels of participation and interest
- Competitive environment
- Timing and duration factors
- Talent requirements
- Climate
- Access
- Marketing and promotional issues.

Element 2: Establish concept, theme and format of event

2.1 Meet both customer needs and expectations in accordance with organisation standards, policies and procedures and within acceptable time frames

Introduction

Once all relevant details have been identified, it is now time for event organisers to prepare and present information to the client in a manner which:

- Reflects their requirements
- Contains all information in a clear and logical format
- Meets their expectations
- Follows all organisation standards, policies and procedures
- Is presented in a timely manner.



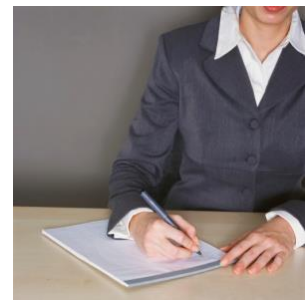
The focus of Section 2 of this manual is an explanation of the steps associated with preparing this information for approval by the client.

Before we explore how to prepare information for the client, it is important to identify the different types of organisation standards, policies and procedures that must be taken into account when preparing and operating events and functions as it ensures that all necessary actions, right from the initial quotation follow organisational requirements and expectations.

Organisational standard report forms

When preparing information for a client a number of documents are prepared including, but not limited to:

- Event Brief
- Contract
- Booking Conditions
- Confirmation Forms
- Function Running Sheets
- Catering Operational Plan
- Catering Running Sheet
- Invoices & Accounts
- Customer Comment and Feedback Forms.



Position descriptions

Position descriptions are often also known as 'job descriptions' and 'duty statements'.

Like in any department of a hospitality establishment, they are important in the organising and running of events and functions.

The use of position descriptions are very important in any team as they identify what each team member is responsible to undertake. This is vital in events where large numbers of staff are employed, each performing a range of activities.

The purpose of position descriptions is to provide employees with information about their jobs, including responsibilities, roles and tasks. It normally also indicates expected standards of performance.

A consistent format should be used for position descriptions in organisations so that they demonstrate a relationship between positions and that they are managed in the same way.

Generally, a 'good' position description will include:

- A confirmation of the details in a contract, such as position title and commencement date
- The purpose of the position and relationships with a group
- Information that describes how the position is performed successfully (KPIs).



Company policy documents

There are a number of other documents that are used to ensure activities comply with organisational requirements including:

- Checklists – clearly indicate the tasks to be performed
- Performance Indicators – indicate the expected level of desired performance
- Policies – rules or guidelines of expected performance
- Procedures – specified step by step guide how an activity is to be conducted
- SOPs – Standard Operating Procedures.



Code of ethics

Codes of ethics are documents that help assist staff to understand the difference between 'right' and 'wrong' and apply that understanding to their decisions. An ethical code generally implies documents at three levels:

- Codes of business ethics
- Codes of conduct for employees
- Codes of professional practice.



Performance standards

Every job has standards of performance that are required to be met by the employee undertaking that job.

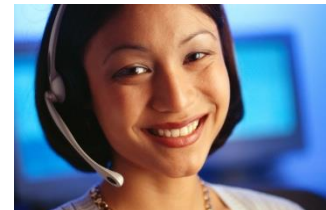
These standards should be linked to the organisation's competitive strategies which allow the organisation to achieve its objectives and goals.

Performance standards are targets and, where possible, should be expressed objectively. That means expressing the standard in quantifiable terms such as:

- How to present information to a client
- How to confirm an event
- How to set up for different types of functions.

Standards of performance may be developed in relation to:

- Productivity
- Punctuality
- Personal presentation
- Level of accuracy in work performed
- Adherence to procedures
- Customer service standards
- Team interaction
- Response or waiting times.



Job behaviour standards

As well as having performance standards for the various jobs, an organisation will also have job behaviour standards for employees.

These behaviour standards, when met, ensure the individual behaves in a manner that also allows others to achieve their job standards. This allows the organisation to retain consistency throughout its operations.

2.2 Develop an overall event concept, theme and format which reflects key objectives agreed upon with customer/s and/or key stakeholders

Introduction

Once the key objectives and requirements of an event or function have been outlined and the expected organisational standards, policies and procedures have been clarified, it is now time to prepare an event brief. An event brief is the template which contains all necessary information relating to a catered event or function.

This will be the primary document used to prepare a proposal. It also clearly identifies a range of event considerations.

This event brief is then used as the template for a 'Function sheet' (sometimes also known as an 'event order' or 'function order') that is an internal communication form that sets out the details of a function.



Content of an event brief

Naturally an event brief will only be as detailed as the depth of discussions carried out between the event organiser and the client, but some details that will be included may be:

- Agreed event details – including concept, theme, format and protocols
- Identification of stakeholders – and their individual roles
- Allocation of responsibilities and setting of milestones and task completion dates
- Type of function – wedding, launch of product, ball
- Name, address, and contact number of client
- Day, date and time of the function
- Rooms and locations where the function will be held
- Castings – where determined
- Billing instructions – who gets the bill, their address
- Menu – break-down course-by-course of the agreed dishes
- Beverage arrangements – description and quantities of beverages to be provided
- Sequence of service – covering timing of service, and details of when speeches and presentations will occur
- Entertainment – details of bands and the order of ceremony
- Room set up – number of tables, floor plan, decorations, table set-ups (cutlery, crockery and table accoutrements)
- Type of service – plated, tray, buffet, silver service, finger food
- Special requirements – commonly relating to technology requirements such as microphone, DVD facilities, data projector, sound and lighting.



2.3 Verify practicality and viability of concept, theme and format through a sound process of consultation and analysis

Introduction

As mentioned in Section 2.2, the purpose of an event brief is to develop a starting point in which to document the requirements of an event.

Once this has been completed, it is important to clarify and seek approval from different stakeholders within the organisation, to ensure that what is going to be proposed to the client is:

- Accurate
- Possible to perform.

Importance of consulting with internal stakeholders

Communication throughout the planning, preparation and delivery of an event is vital to ensure that all internal stakeholders are not only aware of what they need to do, but also how it interrelates or impacts other stakeholders.

All successful functions are a result of effective teamwork.

This highlights the need to involve others in the planning phase so that the implementation works as required.

It is vital you appreciate the need to proactively include others in the planning stage, especially those who will be participating in the preparation and execution of the function.

Never be afraid of asking for input from people in relation to planning these occasions.

Types of assistance

There are many types of assistance that may be required, either to be given or received, by different stakeholders in a function, including:

- Seeking advice or suggestions
- Confirming information
- Updating them about preparations and purchases
- Undertaking logistical activities and arrangements
- Assisting them to meet function requirements.



Who might be involved?

The following is indicative of who you may liaise with when planning a function:

- Food requirements discussed with Executive Chef
- Beverage requirements discussed with Beverage Manager
- Technical requirements discussed with Maintenance Department or outside suppliers
- Linen requirements discussed with housekeeping – outside suppliers may also be involved
- Room decorations and floral arrangements discussed with housekeeping or outside suppliers
- Facility set-up requirements discussed with Catering and Food and Beverage or functions coordinator
- Security information and requirements discussed with the Security Department
- Arrival and departure information discussed with Front Office Department.

What input can these people make?

Essentially you are asking these people to make input based on:

- Their previous experience
- Their specialist areas of expertise
- Their individual knowledge of the venue, what it can do, what it has to offer and what it has done successfully and unsuccessfully in the past.



Why involve them?

The benefit of involving these people should mean:

- You are more aware of other factors that could impact on the function as a result of information from these people about other happenings in the venue
- The venue avoids repeating previous mistakes they have made in other functions
- The venue is able to play to its strengths in terms of service delivery, staff expertise, facilities etc.

Examples of issues that can be more successfully addressed during planning if the right people are involved include:

- Special needs on the menu to accommodate vegetarians, cultural or special dietary needs
- Advice on a certain aspect of the function relating to the use of technology, specialist equipment etc.
- Availability of specific facilities, rooms, staff, locations, equipment etc.



- Input regarding table setting requirements – specific linen colours, accoutrements, table sizes, table plans, service issues, especially as they relate to timing
- Advice on a particular beverage being available for the function to match beverages with food, to meet cost limitations and to ensure sufficient availability
- Assistance on the possibility of extending liquor trading hours and obtaining authorisation to trade in different areas.

Obtaining advice from others

Seeking advice from colleagues or management is usually done formally at a scheduled meeting where time is allocated for everyone to discuss the function and make input.



Sometimes, however, help may be needed from people without notice.

For example, where you have the client with you in the office, and have to ring a colleague to find an answer to their question. In these cases it is advisable to say something like “Chef, I have Mr Walsh with me in the office. He wants some information on our \$40 per head set menu – have you got a minute to speak to us?”

Notifying the person on the other end of the phone that the client is with you can help avoid many potentially embarrassing situations. The same advice holds true of you are phoning a supplier to make an enquiry.

2.4 Identify logistical requirements of overall concept, theme and format

Introduction

There are a number of logistical requirements that need to be determined when preparing for an event or function.

Throughout this manual, especially in Sections 1.1, 1.2 and 2.2, a range of event requirements, often dictated by the client, has been identified.

This section will explore some of the logistical requirements that event coordinators will need to consider when clarifying overall concept, theme and format of an event.

Venue/Location

One of the key logistical requirements when preparing for an event is to ensure the right venue or location is chosen. This is normally the first consideration event organisers will have. They will want to ensure that the venue selected is suitable for what they need to achieve during the event.

Venue/location considerations

In many cases there are a number of considerations, some of which include:

- Location in relation to office, public transport or potential audience. It is normal to select a location that is close to where people are coming from. Normally the closer the better as it keeps travel time and inconvenience to a minimum. This is important where events involve alcohol
- Indoor/outdoor – whilst most conferences and meetings are conducted indoors, there are many events that are better suited to an outdoor location. This is especially true with team building activities or weddings
- Venue quality or brand. Given that many events involve large expenses, many businesses will choose a venue that has a strong brand name, reputation and a 'superior' image
- Space – where events require large areas of space or need to accommodate large numbers of participants, such as an exhibition or wedding, large open rooms will be required
- Reputation – naturally most event organisers will select a location or organisation with a proven reputation for high service levels
- Aesthetic appeal – many weddings are selected due to the visual beauty of room or immediate surroundings
- Accommodation – some events draw participants from different locations and hence need accommodation rooms
- Venue facilities and services – most event organisers have a desire for an establishment which is modern and fresh. In addition many high tech meetings will require a venue with specific audio visual capability
- Cost – this is a key requirement as everyone seeks value for money and must also meet budget constraints.



Potential event locations

There are endless possible event locations but include:

- Hotels
- Resorts
- Restaurants
- Homes for private functions
- Schools, university and other educational providers
- Meetings rooms
- Banquet rooms
- Convention halls
- Exhibition centres
- Reception wedding centres
- Nature areas including open water, zoos, parks, wineries
- Transportation vehicles – including planes, yachts, cars, buses
- Festivals
- Sporting venues
- Government buildings and civic centres
- Museums.



Catering

Types of event factors that impact on catering

The types and styles of food and beverage menus will vary greatly depending on:

- Available budget
- Dates and time of function
- Numbers of participants
- Speed of service required due to timing demands on activities within an event
- Types of food required
- Service styles required
- Cuisines preferred
- Location of event
- Seasonal influences
- Nature of event
- Production and transport issues
- General logistics
- Staffing
- Pre and post function activities.



Menu considerations

The knowledge on organizing and conceptualizing a function must be correlated to the foodstuffs to be prepared.

Most organisations will have a varied selection of different menu options taking into consideration:

- Styles of functions – whether food and beverage is a main aspect of the function (such as a banquet) or to supplement a function (such as a coffee break during a meeting)
- Styles of service required –including plated service, silver service, semi-plated service, stand-up finger food, buffet, a la carte, table d'hôte or set menu options
- Timing of functions. Depending on the time available for the consumption of food and beverage, some options may be more appropriate than others
- Providing a variety of price points. This is important so that the client can choose a specific price point and quality of food and beverage offering to meet their needs and budgets
- Having inclusive and non-inclusive menus. Depending on the participants some clients may wish to have a one price option which covers everything or is happy to pay for each item consumed. These options will be discussed in more detail later in this section.



Staffing

One of the key requirements when planning for a function is to ensure that you are adequately staffed for the event.

Impacts on staffing

The amount and type of staff required to service a function will greatly depend on the:

- Type of function
- Service requirements
- Numbers attending
- Level of service required
- Host of associated miscellaneous details.

Sometimes the number of staff required are determined by the client. The budget they have available will dictate staffing levels.



Sometimes the venue will 'contribute' staff where this is deemed appropriate. This may occur when:

- The client is a regular, high-spending client and the venue wishes to make a tangible donation to the function
- The venue wishes to clear, clean and strip a room so it may be quickly re-set and re-used for another function. A room may be used, for example, for a lunch meeting and is also booked for a dinner function the same day. This would require extra staff to organise things and make sure both functions can be accommodated.

Calculating staff numbers

Determining how many staff are needed or can be afforded for a function is based on a number of factors.

Roles to be performed

Each function is unique and therefore a great deal of thought needs to go into what each staff member will be required to do during the actual event. The following provides an overview of staffing needs for different function types:



Breakfast Function – Self-service – Continental Menu

- Staff to set up and service the buffet
- Staff to greet and seat customers
- Waiting staff to clear away unwanted crockery, cutlery and glassware
- Staff to clean up function and set for lunch.

Cocktail Party – Informal Function – Stand up

- Staff to set up function area
- Bar staff to set up and run the bar
- Waiting staff to carry platters of food
- Staff to clean up the area after function.

Formal dinner party

- Staff to set up function area
- Bar staff to set up and run the bar
- Waiting staff to provide semi-silver service to guests
- Staff to clean up the area after function
- Security staff.

General party

- Staff to assist with decorations
- Bar staff to set up and run the bar
- Staff to coordinate and play music (DJ)
- Staff to carry platters of food
- Security staff.

Productivity standards

Importance of standards was identified in Section 2.1 of this manual.

Every job has standards of performance that are required to be met by the employee undertaking that job.

Each organisation will have different 'expected levels of output' required for each staff member depending on the type of activities that they are required to perform.

Performance standards are targets and as such, where possible, should be expressed objectively. Examples of productivity standards may include:

- Food waiters may be expected to serve X number of people
- One bar tender is used to serve X number of customers.

Naturally, depending on the style of service, the expected output will vary but some form of standard will exist. For example staff undertaking silver service will be able to service fewer customers than for a buffet function.



Budget

The person drawing up rosters of functions needs to consider relevant staff budgets that have been allocated to their section.

Issues to note are:

- Forecasting labour costs for the period covered by the roster – how much money is available for staffing
- Ensuring all hours are covered and the wages/labour costs for the roster are within the allowable labour budget for each function.



Many establishments will forecast sales and revenue for the function in question, and that will determine the dollar figure available for labour, because they operate on a 'percentage of sales' labour budget.

In effect, the greater the more revenue generated for a function, the more staff you can use. Correspondingly, less revenue means that fewer staff are available.

This scenario means management allocates the amount that can be spent, and it is up to you how you spend it.

The cost of employing someone does not just mean their wages, but also includes many other costs. Examples of these include workers' compensation insurance, superannuation, payroll tax and leave entitlements.

All supervisors have a responsibility to keep labour costs down while maintaining customer service level. This may be one of the ways your employer judges your workplace performance.

Allocating the right mix of staff

When rostering staff it is essential to use the available skills bases or skill sets and competencies of available staff to match the type of function. This is aimed at obtaining the most effective and appropriate mix of staff to meet different operational requirements and constraints. Given the nature of different functions and the fact that staff are not normally employed on a regular basis in a functions environment, it is essential that there is a 'right mix' of staff.

Consideration of the mix of staff for a specific function is done so the staff who are rostered on complement each other and therefore provide balanced and total service to customers.



Factors influencing the mix of staff

This balance and mix may include attention to:

- The mix of experienced staff and new staff. The new staff may include trainees, those who are newly employed but who may have experience only in other establishments, people on work experience, staff who have just been promoted, and employees who are making a transition, perhaps as part of a multi-skilling focus, into the area but who may have experience within the venue in another department
- The mix of permanent and casually employed staff. Most casual staff do not have the same knowledge or an organisation, know where items are located, how procedures are to be performed and different people who work in the functions and kitchen area, as permanent staff. In addition, they normally will not have the same sense of responsibility as permanent staff. Therefore it is important that there are qualified permanent staff who can help direct, lead and assist casually employed staff
- The mix of males to females. Many establishments prefer a gender balance in their staff to cater for the various needs of their clientele. In addition, there may be certain roles that are traditionally occupied by one gender
- The mix of skilled employees to semi-skilled employees. This also highlights that staff with lots of experience are not necessarily those with skills. Skills and years of service are not always the same, although many staff tend to believe this is in fact the case. You may require a majority of staff in your functions area to have only basic plate carrying, service and clearing skills, while you will always want to have two on duty who have high levels of silver service and gueridon skills
- The mix of language skills. For some functions it could be critical to ensure an adequate mix of people with various language abilities.

Accessing staff

In many cases, functions do not have a ready pool of staff available at its disposal to cater for an event and may need to access staff through:

- Other departments
- Other hotels within the chain
- Specialist contractors
- Casual employment
- Employment agencies.



Venues often keep a list of people they can call on to work at functions. These are predominantly casual staff who have worked on functions at the venue before and who have proved their worth and competency. It is a fact that staff who do not perform at functions are never re-hired.

In addition, some permanent venue staff will be allocated to work the function. These staff may well be more competent or multi-skilled staff who can work quicker, who know the run of the venue better, or who have more function experience and so on. Note that allocating normal dining room staff to a function may leave the dining room understaffed for that time so additional staff have to be hired to backfill that department.

Stock

On most occasions stock will have to be arranged to meet specific needs of a proposed event or function.

This stock reflects the agreed client requirements and may include:

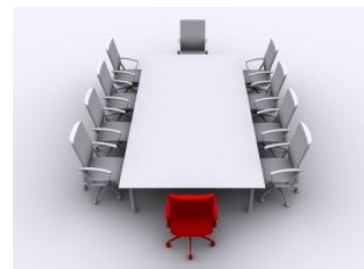
- Specific types/brands of wine or other beverages
- Specific food items from a specialist supplier
- Specific linen items – for example a certain colour of table cloths and napkins
- Specific furniture items.



Furniture

This can include:

- Tables and chairs – for registration areas, speakers and guests
- Surrounding furniture - including catering tables, chairs, coat racks, luggage storage
- Stage – including lectern
- Signage – to be displayed in the room itself, in front of the meeting room and the entrance of the building, including suitable directions
- Aesthetics – flowers, plants, music lighting and temperature.



Equipment

The type of equipment required in an event, especially meetings, may include:

- Computers, printers and scanners
- Photocopiers
- Telephones including teleconference equipment
- Video conference equipment
- Data Projector and screen
- Audi Speakers
- Internet connection or 'wi-fi'
- Microphone (cordless or fixed), stand and speakers
- Whiteboards and electronic whiteboards
- Flip carts, butchers paper and pens
- Lectern including light
- DVD Player and TV screen
- Lighting
- Camera and video player.

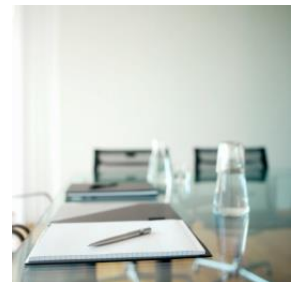


Stationery

It is important that all participants have all the necessary tools at their disposal to record information. Most participants will expect these to be provided.

Effective meeting planners will arrange:

- Pens and pads
- Name badges
- Place settings
- Water glass and pitchers
- Mints/candy dishes.



Outdoor event logistical requirements

With outdoor events and functions becoming more popular, it is important to explore the different considerations and logistical requirements that need to be considered.

As can be seen, more thought needs to be placed on types of logistical requirements for outdoor events in more cases than for indoor events.

Outdoor event considerations

- Food, beverage or alcohol
- Tables, chairs, stage, grounds keeping, toilets etc.
- Tent, sheltered or enclosed spaces
- Sound and lighting systems
- Merchandise sales
- Types of customers
- Security
- Transportation, traffic and parking
- Entertainment
- Ticket sales
- Weather back up plans
- Permits or special licenses
- Local council restrictions.



Whilst there are endless types of logistical considerations some common ones include:

Power and water supply

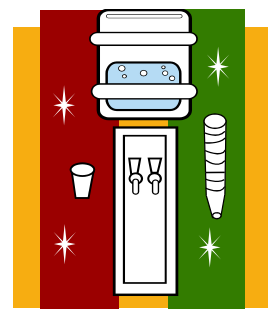
Most events need some power or water supply. This is used for:

- Lighting
- Emergency Lighting
- Toilets
- Cooking and cleaning
- Equipment.

Food and beverage equipment

There is no doubt that with many outdoor events the provision of food and beverage is a necessity. With the provision of food and beverage comes the need for equipment including:

- Cooking equipment – e.g. ovens, stoves, microwaves, shelving, washing stations, preparation and service tables
- Beverage equipment – e.g. fridges, freezers (also used for food), blenders, ice machines, beer kegs and mechanisms.



Tables, chairs and related items

If food and beverage is to be served, there will no doubt be the need for tables, chairs, crockery, cutlery, glassware, candles, service stations and service equipment.

Environmental control

It is important that the holding of an event does not cause damage to the environment or become a disturbance to local residents. Therefore measures must be put in place when managing:

This includes:

- Air conditioning
- Sound
- Lighting
- Privacy
- Fencing and security
- Screening from public gaze/access.



Toilets

Toilet facilities are an essential part of every event. Care must be given to the set up, management and removal of facilities and human waste.



Emergency services

As part of a contingency program, adequate thought must be given to the use of emergency services.

These services can include:

- Fire
- Medical
- Police
- First Aid kits.



Car and coach parking

It is unlikely that guests will arrive to an event on foot, therefore consideration must be paid to access to parking of vehicles.

Thought must also be given to the integration with other transport options, including public transport systems.

Disabled access

Special thought must be given to access to various event locations for disabled patrons. This might include the need for dedicated parking areas, ramps or designated seating areas.

Signage

Signage is an essential part of an event which not only identifies an event and the key attraction locations, but also provides vital information in relation to toilets, medical facilities, exits, policies and procedures and event information.

Signage and other arrangements must also consider the needs of people who may have language difficulties or barriers.

Waste management

At every event some element of waste will build up. It is important that plans are put into place for the storage and removal of waste from a venue location.

It is important to have cleaning services, grounds keeping functions, waste bins and recycling containers.

Animals and insects

Whether it be spiders, flies, mosquitoes, baboons or other animals and insects it is wise to prepare for them. It may be a case of supplying repellent, citronella candles through to spraying or having fly covers for food.

Weather considerations

If an event is to be held outdoors, considerations and contingencies must be made in the event of rain, extreme sunshine, heat or inclement weather. This could be the need for:

- Tents
- Marquees / pavilions
- Side screens
- Indoor venue as an alternative
- Rain equipment or clothing – in the event of gold events where the whole location cannot be covered
- Air-conditioners – in the event of hot weather
- Portable heaters – in the event of cold weather
- Sunscreen
- Additional water.



Entertainment infrastructure

In many outdoor events and festivals some form of entertainment may be arranged ranging from a speaker to make announcements through to elaborate rock concert settings.

This equipment is often sourced by specialist providers or by companies who conduct the complete set up and breakdown.

Equipment can include:

- Staging
- Lighting
- Fireworks
- Speakers
- Flood lights
- Electrical wiring and provision
- Back stage areas and portable rooms.



2.5 Obtain relevant approval from customer/s and/or stakeholders prior to implementation

Once all necessary event considerations have been identified, considered and confirmed it is now time to prepare a detailed proposal and quotation.

In essence this is an expanded version of the Event Brief that was detailed in [Section 2.2](#) of this manual.

By preparing an event brief, an event proposal can be constructed for the consideration of the client.

All potential clients will need to be supplied with a proposal and quotation for their function before they commit to booking it and paying a deposit.

This section will explore some of the steps associated with clarifying and approving information for presentation to the client.

The next section will detail what information is actually included in the proposal and the importance of obtaining agreement by the client.

The critical nature of quotations

Providing a quotation to a client is a serious business.

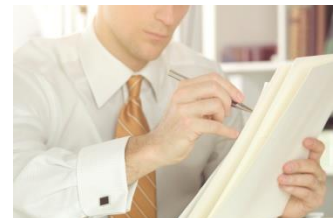
If the cost is too high, the client may elect not to proceed with the function.

If the quote is too low, the venue may not make enough profit or could even lose money.

Provide overview of how you can meet or exceed client expectations

Given that the client will usually collect proposals and quotations from a number of competing hotels it is essential that you are able to detail how you can meet or hopefully exceed their expectations.

These 'unique selling points' must be clear in their definition and how they are to be achieved or provided.



Factors to take into account when developing a costing

The following are important points to bear in mind when developing a costing:

Follow house policies

Every venue will have its own protocols for determining the final cost for a function and it is essential you adhere to these. Where there is a chance to be involved with senior staff when they meet a client and cost a function, you should take advantage of that opportunity.

Make sure everything is charged for

It is essential that all charges which can be legitimately charged for are included in the quotation.

The information gathered from the initial meeting with the client together with subsequent contacts with the client will provide the basis for this.

Only include services and products the client has requested

While you are expected to suggest and pursue additional sales opportunities with all clients, the quotation should only cover the items that have been confirmed with the client.

If house policy requires additional potential services and products are included as part of the quotation they should be contained on a separate page and quite clearly indicated as options and not as part of the final quote.

Double-check your figures

It should be standard procedure to check and double-check all figures contained in the quote.

This need to check and double-check applies to:

- In-house charges for accommodation rooms, provision of in-house services (spa treatments, room hire, use of nominated facilities)
- Goods and services to be provided by external providers. Always check with suppliers to get up-to-date and accurate quotes from them regarding goods and services they are to provide
- Confirming house policy regarding charging for third party suppliers. Where the venue is using external providers to supply nominated goods and services you must know what the venue policy is regarding how these charges are to be passed on to the client. Some venues may charge these out 'at cost' and some may add a certain percentage as a fee to cover the time involved in arranging things
- Arithmetic calculations. You must check all your additions or extensions are correct
- Including any discounts that may apply. These may apply to certain Very Important People (VIP) clients, or by virtue of their membership of some club or organisation.

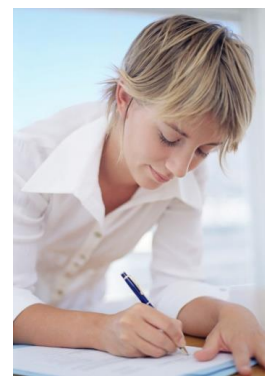
Identify and explain every charge

It is standard procedure to ensure each and every charge the client is being asked to pay is individually identified and priced.

The intention is to provide the client with a detailed, clear and unambiguous quotation with no hint of deception or hidden costs.

In practice this means there can be a need to specify:

- The number of accommodation rooms included in the quotation and the type of room and in-room facilities
- Where a three course meal is offered, the choices available for each course
- Where wine is being provided as part of the catering the number of bottles, the type and brand, style, vintage
- Where refreshments are being provided on arrival or during breaks, exactly what will be provided
- If extra security is being charged for the number of security staff, the service they will be providing.



Observe promises made

Where you have promised the client certain facilities and services, it is essential these are included in the quotation to confirm to the client they will be provided.

Where you have promised the client their quotation will be provided by a given date, this promise must also be met. In the mind of the client, if you can't get the quotation done as promised it does not give them confidence in your ability to execute the function.

Verify with management

Always get management to double-check any quotation before it is presented to the client. Never present a quotation to a client unless you have specific authority to do so.

The experience and operational knowledge that management have can often raise an issue, cost or operating issue that you are unaware of and that has significant impact on the quotation.



Preparing for delivery of the proposal

Prepare materials

It is important to prepare a range of materials that may be used to illustrate the planned actions.

These include:

- Quotation, including detailed list of activities and costings
- Bid materials, promotional materials and visual presentations that will be used in the meeting with the client.

What is actually included in the concept plan or proposal will be detailed in the next section.

Work Projects

It is a requirement of this Unit that you complete Work Projects as advised by your Trainer. You must submit documentation, suitable evidence or other relevant proof of completion of the project to your Trainer by the agreed date.

2.1 To fulfil the requirements of this Work Project you are asked to, based on the event in Work Project 1:

- Prepare an event brief
 - Identify which internal stakeholders you would consult with to either gain assistance or confirm content of the event brief
 - Identify logistical requirements of event including:
 - Venue / Location
 - Catering
 - Staffing
 - Stock
 - Furniture
 - Equipment
 - Stationery
 - Outdoor event logistical requirements (if appropriate).
-

Summary

Establish concept, theme and format of event

Meet both customer needs and expectations in accordance with organisation standards, policies and procedures and within acceptable time frames

- Organisational standard report forms
- Position descriptions
- Company policy documents
- Code of ethics
- Performance standards
- Job behaviour standards.

Develop an overall event concept, theme and format which reflects key objectives agreed upon with customers and/or key stakeholders

- Content of an event brief.

Verify practicality and viability of concept, theme and format through a sound process of consultation and analysis

- Importance of consulting with internal stakeholders
- Types of assistance
- Who might be involved?
- What input can these people make?
- Why involve them?
- Obtaining advice from others.

Identify logistical requirements of overall concept, theme and format

- Venue / Location
- Catering
- Staffing
- Stock
- Furniture
- Equipment
- Stationery
- Outdoor event logistical requirements.

Obtain relevant approval from customers and/or stakeholders prior to implementation

- The critical nature of quotations
- Provide overview of how you can meet/exceed client expectations
- Factors to take into account when developing a costing
- Observe promises made
- Verify with management
- Preparing for delivery of the proposal.

Element 3: Prepare a concept plan

3.1 Document theme and operational context of the event or function

Introduction

As mentioned, once all the event details have been internally confirmed and verified, it is now time to prepare and send the proposal.

Prepare proposal

Inclusions in a catering proposal

In summary an event catering proposal should include:

- Details of all catering proposed, including menus, drinks, timing, service times
- Costs
- Options available within designated budget parameters
- Overview of production, transportation and service of food and beverages
- Staff numbers
- Reference to previous events that have been catered for on the same or similar scale.

In many cases a proposal will include a summary of information on the first page and then a detailed list of options that are available including costs.

On the following pages is an example of a proposal that provides information that can be used for most events within a hotel.



EVENT PROPOSAL

Date:
To:
TEL:
FAX:

From:
TEL:
FAX:
RE: Event Proposal
PAGES: (incl. cover)

Hi,

Following is a proposal for your event as requested. Please call for further assistance.

EVENT(S):

DATE(S):

TIMES:

GUESTS: (to be confirmed)

LOCATION:

ROOM HIRE:

ROOM STYLE:

CATERING: Please refer to menus attached and advise us of your selection.

EQUIPMENT: Please refer to list attached and advise of equipment requirements.

PARKING: Complimentary underground security parking is provided, subject to availability.

ACCOMM: We are pleased to offer any of your delegates who may require accommodation our conference rate of \$160.00 + tax, per single occupancy room.

PAYMENT: Please advise us on your preferred method of payment; should you wish to be invoiced, please call and we will send you a credit application; otherwise, credit card details are requested for full payment.

CONFIRMING: Please email confirmation, with details regarding catering, equipment and timing for catering if possible.

Have a great day

ROOM SPECIFICATIONS

Each of our banquet rooms has been designed and tastefully decorated to suit the requirements of every function.

‘A’ Room is appropriate for meetings, training seminars, intimate wedding receptions and other smaller luncheons and dinners. This room can be separated to cater for smaller functions or combined to accommodate up to 120 theatre style.

‘B&C’ Rooms are ideal for larger conferences, video conferencing and cocktail parties. This room can accommodate up to 120 people for a formal dinner or 250 guests for a cocktail party or theatre style convention.

The Executive Boardroom caters especially for the business executive. It includes a custom designed boardroom table, built in television monitor and VHS recorder. With breathtaking views, the Executive Boardroom is also perfect for small dinners, product displays or that special cocktail party.

Private meeting rooms and executive suites with lake, ocean or park views are also available.

FUNCTION ROOM	AREA (m ²)	COCKTAIL	THEATRE	BANQUET	CLASS ROOM	U-SHAPE
A	171	250	230	120	100	50
B&C	190	150	120	70	60	36
B	112	80	70	50	30	25
C	78	40	50	30	20	20
Executive Boardroom	42	40	30	24	Boardroom 24	-
Parkview Suite	34	30	20	12	Boardroom 12	-

All conference rooms come with an overhead projector and screen, flipchart and whiteboard as well as many items on request such as Blu-Tak, scissors, marker pens and other last minute essentials.

Room Hire Charges

‘A’	\$700.00
‘B’	\$400.00
‘C’	\$350.00
‘B&C’	\$550.00
Executive Boardroom	\$400.00
Parkview Boardroom	\$350.00

ACCOMMODATION

Hotel A has 170 deluxe rooms with extensive harbour and parkland views. One and two bedroom suites with kitchen facilities are also available.

Our special conference delegate rate:

Rates

Deluxe Single Room	\$160.00 per night
Deluxe Twin Share	\$170.00 per night
Residential Package	\$254.00 per night

Room Facilities

Individually controlled air conditioning and heating	CNN News
Bath and shower	International direct dial telephones
Hair drier	Tea and coffee making facilities
Mini bar and refrigerator	Desk or bureau
Iron and ironing board	Remote control colour television
24 hour room service	Laundry/valet service
In-house movies	In-room account and message review

Business Facilities and Complimentary Services

24 hour reception	Secretarial services
Express check out	Photocopying, printing and faxing
Daily newspapers	Complimentary passes to the local gym
Frequent Flyer points	Courtesy shuttle bus service to local business area

Car Parking

Complimentary undercover car parking is available for all residential conference delegates.

EQUIPMENT

Hotel A prides itself in providing the latest technology and high quality equipment to enable you to conduct your conferences with professionalism and flare.

Equipment Available

Equipment	Cost of hire per day
Whiteboard with pen set and duster (Additional \$25.00)	Complimentary
Flipchart with pen set and paper (Additional \$25.00)	Complimentary
Overhead projector and screen (Additional \$40.00)	Complimentary
Portable CD player	Complimentary
Sound system including lectern, microphone, amplifier and speakers	Complimentary
Electronic whiteboard - 2 screen	\$130.00
Slide projector and screen	\$60.00
Video and monitor	\$60.00
Lapel microphone	\$50.00

Additional audio visual aids can be arranged with our Banquet Department prior to the commencement of your conference.

Complimentary Conference Aids

- Iced water and mints on conference tables
- A4 note pads and pens
- Conference Concierge - dedicated to providing specialised attention to all your conference needs.

Video Conferencing

Hotel A offers ISDN Video Conferencing. This state of the art technology provides a faster, more cost effective way of communicating with people across the country and the world. It can be used for conferences, board meetings, training seminars, remote expert consultation, presentations and product launches. For further information, please contact our Banquet Department.

CONFERENCE PACKAGES

Allow us to take the stress out of your conference planning. Everything you need for a full day conference is included, plus those little extras which highlight your days of conferencing!

- One set price
- Concentrate on the conference not the catering
- No hidden costs
- Allows you to be flexible and us to be innovative!

Day Conference Package

\$49.00 per person (minimum 20 people)

Includes:

- Room hire
- Brewed coffee, tea and mini muffins on arrival
- Morning coffee, tea and home baked cookies
- Afternoon coffee, tea and chocolate brownies
- Working lunch
- Overhead projector, whiteboard and flipchart.

DAY CONFERENCE MENUS

Working Style Lunch

\$21.50 per person or inclusive in the Day Conference package

MENU ONE

A selection of Mediterranean filled piderolls

Roast pumpkin, baby spinach & pinenut salad

Fresh fruit and cheese platter

Coffee, tea and orange juice

MENU THREE

Selection of Italian pizzettes

Caesar salad

Fruit Platter

Orange juice, Tea & Coffee

MENU TWO

Selection of Laviash Rolls

Potato Salad

Fruit Platter

Coffee, tea and orange juice

MENU FOUR

Selection of gourmet sandwiches

Greek Salad

Fruit & Cheese platter

Orange juice, Tea & Coffee

MENU FIVE

Mediterranean buffet served in Restaurant.

A full selection of dishes that have made the countries of the Mediterranean famous, including grilled chorizo, marinated calamari, artichokes, tzatziki, couscous and more.

All menus come with coffee, tea and orange juice.

Please note 1/3 of each of these menus is vegetarian.

Ask our Banquet Department about our Residential Package.

BREAKFAST MENUS

Breakfast is the most important meal of the day. Get your conference off to a flying start with a healthy and nutritious breakfast.

Continental

Chilled fruit juices
Fresh fruit platter
Assorted pastries, croissants and muffins
Selection of jams and preserves
Brewed coffee and tea

\$14.50 per person

Health Plate

Chilled fruit and vegetable juices
Selection of yoghurts and fresh fruits
Muesli Bar - make your own muesli
Scrambled eggs with mushrooms
Grilled tomatoes on the side
Wholemeal toast and muffins
Brewed coffee, decaffeinated coffee and tea selection

\$16.00 per person

Country Buffet

Chilled fruit juices
Assorted pastries
Fresh fruits and compotes
Cereal and muesli bar
Scrambled eggs
Bacon slices and sausages from the griddle
Mushrooms, tomatoes and hashbrowns
Toast selection
Jams and preserves
Brewed coffee and tea

\$19.00 per person

Big Breakfast Buffet

Champagne and orange juice
Chilled fruit juices
Assorted pastries and croissants
Fresh fruits and compotes
Assorted cereal and muesli bar
Flapjacks with maple syrup and whipped butter
Scrambled eggs with smoked salmon, sour cream and chives
Thick slices of leg ham, smoked bacon and sausages
Mushrooms, tomatoes and hashbrowns
Muffins and toast selection
Selection of jams and preserves
Brewed coffee and tea

\$24.50 per person

COFFEE BREAKS

Make your morning or afternoon break something special with the following temptations!

Coffee and tea with shortbreads and cookies	\$4.00
Milkshakes and smoothies with cinnamon doughnuts	\$5.50
Devonshire tea with scones, jam and cream	\$5.00
Coffee and tea with banana cake and carrot slice	\$6.50
Coffee and tea with individual chocolate and mocha éclairs	\$6.50
Coca Cola with assorted chocolate bars	\$6.00
Coffee, tea and homemade mini muffins	\$4.50
All day continuous coffee and tea	\$8.00
Themed Coca Cola Conference Break	\$6.50

BREAK WITH A DIFFERENCE

We take pride in providing something a little out of the ordinary to surprise and impress your delegates.

For a break with a twist, try these suggestions:

Revitaliser

An abundance of fresh whole fruit
Freshly chilled juices
A healthy mix of dried fruits and nuts
Full and low fat yoghurts on ice

\$6.50 per person

Energiser

To put that extra zing into your conference break:
A selection of health and energy bars
Freshly made fruit smoothies

\$6.50 per person

Chocoliser

A little indulgence to keep the team going:
Copious amounts of chocolate treats
Smooth chocolate malt milkshakes

\$6.50 per person

Ask us about even more ideas to brighten up those inevitable moments of information overload.

BANQUET MENUS

Whether you require a luncheon, a supper for six or a formal dinner for sixty, our Executive Chef and his team will make your function an occasion to remember.

Naturally, we are only too happy to cater for guests with special dietary needs. Please inform our Banquet Department when you make your booking for any special requests.

We can also design a menu to suit your taste and budget.

Menu One

Caesar salad

Charred breast of chicken with baked polenta
and grilled vegetables with a balsamic vinegar jus

Apple and cinnamon pudding with King Island double cream

Coffee and tea

\$30.00 per person

Menu Two

Baked tomato tart with parmesan and vine-ripened tomato

Herb crusted rack of lamb served with dauphinoise potato
and a minted red wine demi glace

Sticky toffee pudding with butterscotch sauce

Coffee, tea and petit fours

\$30.00 per person

Menu Three

Sugar cured salmon with a mustard dill sauce and lavoche

Oven roasted loin of veal with a pommery mustard crust
served on wild mushrooms and potato

Pear and almond tart with crème anglaise

Coffee, tea and petit fours

\$35.00 per person

Menu Four

Oriental chicken salad with soya mirin vinaigrette on Asian greens

Individual fillet mignon served on rosti potato
with a green peppercorn sauce and caramelised onion

Chocolate mud cake with vanilla bean ice cream

Coffee, tea and petit fours

\$37.00 per person

BUFFET MENUS

Selection One

Your choice of one of the following:

- Boned chicken wings with stir fried vegetables
- Sautéed beef with capsicum and onions
- Braised veal with garden fresh vegetables in a creamy sauce
- Sautéed chicken with mushrooms and bacon in a red wine sauce
- The choicest of seafood in a spicy casserole

Plus: An array of cold meats and small goods
 Salad bar and a selection of dressings
 Seasonal fruit platter and dessert selection
 Assorted local and imported cheeses with crackers
 Bread selection
 Coffee and tea

\$30.00 per person

Selection Two

Your choice of two of the following:

- Boned chicken wings with stir fried vegetables
- Sautéed beef with capsicum and onions
- Braised veal with garden fresh vegetables in a creamy sauce
- Sautéed chicken with mushrooms and bacon in a red wine sauce
- The choicest of seafood in a spicy casserole

Plus Chef's carvery: Your choice of one of the following:

- Roast loin of pork with peach and cashew stuffing
- Leg of veal with pistachio stuffing

Plus: An array of cold meats, terrines and smallgoods with pickles and chutneys
 Soup kettle with crusty bread
 Creamed potatoes and buttered vegetables
 Salad bar and a selection of dressings
 Seasonal fruit platter and dessert selection
 Assorted local and imported cheeses with crackers
 Bread selection
 Coffee, tea and petit fours

\$36.00 per person

BEVERAGE PACKAGES

Whether it's a quiet drink after a hectic day in conference or a cocktail party for 200, Hotel A has a variety of beverage options to suit all your requirements.

Liquor Package One

Local beers, house red and white wine, local sparkling wine, orange juice and soft drinks.

First hour or part of	\$8.00 per person
Two hours	\$13.50 per person
Every hour thereafter	\$4.50 per person

Liquor Package Two

House spirits, local beers, house red and white wine, local sparkling wine, orange juice and soft drinks

First hour or part of	\$11.00 per person
Two hours	\$17.50 per person
Every hour thereafter	\$5.50 per person

Beverages by the Glass

House Chardonnay	\$3.50
House Shiraz	\$3.50
Local 375 ml bottled beer	\$3.50
Imported beer	from \$4.50
Spirits - Standard	\$3.50
Spirits - Premium	\$4.50
Liqueurs - Premium	\$4.50
Liqueurs - Deluxe	\$5.50
Orange Juice - Jug	\$6.00
Orange Juice - Glass	\$2.50
Soft Drinks - Jug	\$6.00
Soft Drinks - Glass	\$2.00
Mineral Water - Jug	\$6.00
Mineral Water - Glass	\$2.50

Open Cash Bar - Guests purchase drinks at their own expense.

COCKTAIL PARTIES

Mix business with pleasure at an informal cocktail reception. It's the perfect way to end a long working day or entertain, and we have something to suit everyone's taste and budget.

Conference Completion Package \$17.00 per person

Beer, wine and soft drinks with the Chef's selection of Mediterranean nibbles served in Cocktail Bar. One hour duration.

Menu One

Two hours of beer, wine and soft drinks plus:

- Mezze platters of olives, babaganoush, tzatziki, hommos, taramasalata, roasted capsicum, chorizo and grilled flat breads.

\$25.00 per person

Menu Two

Two hours of beer, wine and soft drinks plus:

- Smoked salmon and dill roulade on pumpernickel
- Chinese pork and roasted peanut tartlets
- Crostini with olive tapenade and aioli
- Gourmet mini pizzas with various toppings such as roasted artichoke, prosciutto, rocket, goats' cheese, capsicum and eggplant
- Lamb, cumin and pine nut meat balls with minted yoghurt
- Kangaroo chipolatas with bush tomato chutney.

\$27.50 per person

Menu Three

Two hours of beer, wine and soft drinks plus:

- Seared rare tuna on rice crackers with wasabi mayonnaise
- Peking duck crepes with hoi sin sauce
- Goats' cheese, roasted capsicum and rocket bruschettas
- Crisp flat bread with babaganoush and hommos
- Mini fillet steak sandwiches with onion marmalade
- Marinated chicken skewers with spicy peanut sauce
- Tandoori lamb fillet on crisp pappadums
- Shiitake mushroom and onion tartlets.

\$30.00 per person

COCKTAIL PARTIES

Your choice of:

Any **six** hors d'oeuvres plus bowls of crisps, nuts, olives, corn chips, platters of vegetable crudités with spicy guacamole, bacon and sour cream dips.

\$13.00 per person

Any **eight** hors d'oeuvres plus bowls of crisps, nuts, olives, corn chips, platters of vegetable crudités with spicy guacamole, bacon and sour cream dips.

\$17.00 per person

Any **ten** hors d'oeuvres plus bowls of crisps, nuts, olives, corn chips, platters of vegetable crudités with spicy guacamole, bacon and sour cream dips.

\$20.00 per person

Simply choose from the following hot and cold hors d'oeuvres:

Cold

- Mini potato and onion tortilla with tomato chutney
- Miniature vegetable frittata
- Sushi - your choice California rolls/salmon/tuna with sticky rice
- Green papaya and lime barquettes
- Assorted finger sandwiches with various fillings
- Mini bagels with smoked trout and horseradish cream
- Rock oysters with Spanish onion and balsamic marinade
- Chilled king prawns with lemon grass and soya dipping sauce
- Thai style chicken tartlets
- Fresh steamed asparagus wrapped in lamb prosciutto
- Slow roasted Roma tomato and bocconcini on crostini with basil pesto
- Fire seared capsicum and rare beef on pita
- Mini croissants filled with smoked turkey and cranberry
- Baked tomato and parmesan tart

Hot

- Trimmed char grilled lamb cutlets with tomato relish
- Tempura vegetables with soya mirin dipping sauce
- Lobster spring rolls with rice vinegar and sweet chilli sauce
- Spinach and ricotta triangles with sweet chilli dipping
- Coconut coated king prawns with a curried mango dip
- Baked crab and avocado tartlet with salmon caviar
- Spicy chicken and shallot spring rolls with plum sauce
- Steamed prawn shao mai with sesame and soya
- Baby potato filled with crisp bacon, chives and sour cream
- Roasted corn fritters with an avocado and tomato salsa
- Poached oysters in the half shell with ginger, sesame and soya
- Spicy calamari rings with aioli

COCKTAIL PARTIES

Select individually any of our hot or cold hors d'oeuvres at only \$3.00 per person, and receive complimentary bowls of crisps, nuts and olives.

Simply choose from the following hot and cold hors d'oeuvres:

Cold

- Mini potato and onion tortilla with tomato chutney
- Miniature vegetable frittata
- Sushi - your choice California rolls/salmon/tuna with sticky rice
- Green papaya and lime barquettes
- Assorted finger sandwiches with various fillings
- Mini bagels with smoked trout and horseradish cream
- Rock oysters with Spanish onion and balsamic marinade
- Chilled king prawns with lemon grass and soya dipping sauce
- Thai style chicken tartlets
- Fresh steamed asparagus wrapped in lamb prosciutto
- Slow roasted Roma tomato and bocconcini on crostini with basil pesto
- Fire seared capsicum and rare beef on pita
- Mini croissants filled with smoked turkey and cranberry
- Baked tomato and parmesan tart

Hot

- Trimmed char grilled lamb cutlets with tomato relish
- Tempura vegetables with soya mirin dipping sauce
- Lobster spring rolls with rice vinegar and sweet chilli sauce
- Spinach and ricotta triangles with sweet chilli dipping
- Coconut coated king prawns with a curried mango dip
- Baked crab and avocado tartlet with salmon caviar
- Spicy chicken and shallot spring rolls with plum sauce
- Steamed prawn shao mai with sesame and soya
- Baby potato filled with crisp bacon, chives and sour cream
- Roasted corn fritters with an avocado and tomato salsa
- Poached oysters in the half shell with ginger, sesame and soya
- Spicy calamari rings with aioli

TERMS AND CONDITIONS

Confirmations of Bookings

Confirmation of a booking must be made in writing within fourteen (14) days of the original booking. If such confirmation is not received, the management reserves the right to cancel the booking. A minimum deposit of 20% of the estimated cost is required at the time of confirmation.

Guaranteed Numbers

A guaranteed number of guests is required two (2) full working days prior to the function. This will be regarded as the minimum number for catering and charging.

Terms of Payment

Credit facilities must be established with the hotel prior to function commencement. When the lead time to a function is less than seven (7) working days, a credit card number must be supplied as security. Total payment is due within seven (7) days after the function.

Cancellation

Hotel A reserves the right to retain deposited monies as a cancellation fee. If a function is cancelled as late as 48 hours (i.e. two working days) prior to its due start, the organisers will be charged the total quoted price of the function.

Insurance

The guest assumes the responsibility for any and all damage or loss of merchandise left in the hotel prior to, during or after the function. Guests should arrange their own insurance.

Damage

The guest assumes responsibility for any and all damage caused by them or by any of their guests, invitees or other persons attending the function, whether in rooms reserved or in part of the hotel.

Adherence to Law

It is understood that the guest will conduct the function in an orderly manner and in compliance with the rules of the Hotel Management and with all applicable laws. The hotel reserves its right under law to refuse service of alcohol if in their opinion this service would contravene the hotel's obligations under the liquor licensing laws of this state.

Substitution

If the rooms reserved cannot be made available for causes beyond the control of the hotel, the hotel reserves the right to substitute similar or comparable accommodation for the function.

Follow up proposal

Within 24 hours of sending out a proposal a follow up call is required. This is used to determine the following:

- If they received the proposal
- If you can be of further assistance
- If you would like to confirm the booking
- This enables the Event Contract to be prepared
- Explain Method Of Payment.



It is a good idea to make a follow up call week later as a secondary follow up call. Explain that dates are filling and there is another enquiry for the requested date. This usually gets a decision out of them.

If they are not going ahead ask why and enter them into the “Lost Business data base”.

3.2 Document elements of the total concept agreed to by customer/s and/or stakeholders

Introduction

Once all details of an event have been finalised and prepared in a proposal, there are three other documents that may be prepared to help coordinate an event or function.

These documents are:

- An Event Management Plan
- A Function Running Sheet.

These documents detail a range of elements that are of importance to an event or function.

Event management plan

This plan takes into consideration all possible scenarios and activities that need either to be planned or addressed.

Inclusions in an event management plan

Event management plan should address planning and preparation issues focusing on event implementation such as:

- Staffing requirements
- Security
- Management of external contractors
- Running sheets
- Briefing papers
- Staging elements or requirements including set ups, rigging, room preparation, seating, tables, audio visual equipment, catering,



security, sound and lighting displays and signage

- Catering arrangements as specified in the event catering plan
- Liaison with stakeholders, dignitaries, delegates and guests, media, sponsors
- Guest/delegate management on arrival, during the event and on departure
- Risk management
- Emergency management
- Performance standards and guidelines
- Traffic management including vehicular control and foot traffic within the venue/site
- Specification of control, command and communication structures including lines of authority
- Scopes of responsibility, identification of key contact details for event managers
- Use of technology
- Timing and co-ordination of services, facilities
- Contingency plans including contingency plans for adverse weather, and other identified high medium level potential risks.

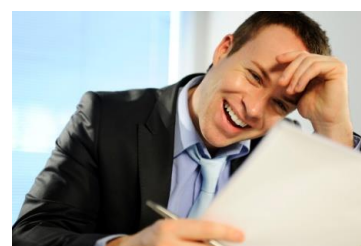


Function sheets

It is standard practice to prepare a function sheet as a means of communicating with staff about an upcoming function.

A function sheet, sometimes also known as an 'event order' or 'function order', is an internal communication form developed to suit each venue's needs that sets out the details of a function such as:

- Type of function – wedding, launch of product, ball
- Name, address, and contact number of client
- Day, date and time of the function
- Rooms and locations where the function will be held
- Billing instructions – who gets the bill, their address
- Menu – break-down course by course of the agreed dishes including specification of 'on arrival' food, morning and afternoon teas
- Beverage arrangements – description and quantities of beverages to be provided
- Sequence of service – timing of service, and details of when speeches and presentations will occur
- Entertainment – details of bands and the order of ceremony
- Room set-up – number of tables, floor plan, decorations, table set-ups including cutlery, crockery and table accoutrements
- Type of service – plated, tray, buffet, silver service, finger food
- Special requirements – technology requirements such as microphone, DVD facilities, data projector, sound and lighting.



Maintaining and updating Function Sheet

Whilst the Function Sheet may be accurate at the time of the function booking and confirmation, there will be changes which need to be updated and communicated to relevant internal departments and external suppliers.

Updating Function Sheet

When any changes to a function are identified the Function Sheet must be updated by:

- Amending Function File on the basis of requests from customer including finalisation of menus and beverages, confirmation of times, and adding new requests for products and services
- Adding details to the file regarding function-related activities including booking of entertainers, confirmation of external services to be provided, and timing of service.

Identification of changes

As more and more changes are made, it may become hard to identify which copy of a Function Sheet is the most updated and accurate.

It is essential that each updated version of the Function Sheet is marked in some way as to identify the version.

This identification can come in the form of a version number depicted by:

- Numerical identification – 1,2,3
- Date identification – identifying date of version.

Discussing changes

It is also important that any updated versions are given to the appropriate people in a timely manner and that they understand the changes that have been made and how they impact the department of staff member.

Email

This can come in the form of an email with the following instructions letting the sender know the status of the email including:

- Notification – when the email has been opened
- Read Receipt – sent by the recipient when they have read and understood the changes.

In person

Updated Function Sheets may be distributed and explained in meetings, allowing all relevant people time to discuss the changes and how best to implement them. Given that the logistics of a function impacts a number of departments, it is essential they all understand and agree on the changes to be made.

Alternatively the function staff member may personally deliver the updated version in hand to ensure that it is not only been given to the correct person, but allows them to discuss updates and changes with different colleagues and staff. This format is used when changes are made at the last minute, which is very common in functions.



3.3 Gain written agreement from customers and/or stakeholders

Introduction

One of the most important aspects of preparing for an event or function is to obtain written agreement from customers.

This normally comes in the form of a signed Event Contract.

This section will explore the steps associated with preparing an Event Contract and seeking agreement from customers.

The Event Contract

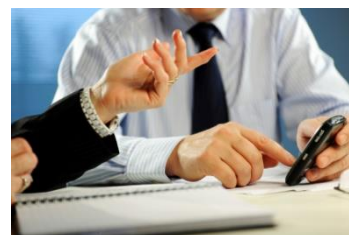
Once the function details have been verbally confirmed with the customer, standard practice requires a written agreement to be drawn up and signed by all parties involved.

This agreement is generally a pro forma document requiring you to simply complete various pieces of 'missing' information.

The function contract is generally sealed by the payment of a deposit to secure the booking.

When negotiations have concluded you must be in possession of the following information which may need to be included in your function contract:

- Full contact details of the client
- Type of function – such as wedding, product launch, or business seminar, including service style (buffet, seated, finger-food), seating arrangements for meals, seminars, group sessions etc.) This indicates how the tables, chairs, stages, head tables and other items of equipment will be laid out
- Dates and times of the function
- Date for notification of final numbers
- Location of the function, name of rooms and facilities to be used
- Approximate numbers attending
- Décor, displays, table decorations etc.
- Food to be served – including when, type, amount
- Beverages to be served – as above
- Entertainment, activities and inclusions
- Ancillary sales – such as accommodation by type, number and dates, tours, in-house services, provision of a Master of Ceremonies (MC) or host, photographers
- Services and facilities the venue has agreed to provide at no charge – such as table for presents, change room for the Bride and Groom, use of pool and gymnasium facilities



- Technology required to support the function – data projectors, stage, sound and lighting requirements, DVD players etc.
- Access required by the client prior to the function
- Products and services the client will be supplying
- Involvement of third party suppliers
- Total cost of function broken down into all the component areas, not just the traditional food and beverage elements. The more items you can point to in this section, the better value-for-money the function will appear to the client
- Deposit amount – the amount you are asking for as a deposit and how that figure was calculated, and when it is payable
- Preferred method and date for final payment. Where an account for final payment is to be forwarded, this section will also include confirmation of who is to get the account and the address where the account is to be sent. Payment by cheque may be acceptable in some instances otherwise cash or more commonly credit card is preferred. Where the venue knows the client and is assured of their credit rating they may be prepared to send an account. Payment is normally required within a relatively short timeframe (7 – 14 days) as opposed to 30 days plus
- Refund policy – explaining the conditions under which the venue is prepared to offer a refund of a deposit, how much the deposit will be
- Payment for extra persons. As previously mentioned a figure should be stated indicating how much the venue will charge if there are additional people attending the function.



Booking conditions

All venues will have specific booking conditions. These will usually appear on the website and form part of the standard function contract.

The conditions will be very specific in what they require of the client but often these are 'diluted' somewhat to accommodate individual client need and to ensure the venue secures the function rather than loses it simply because they refused to be flexible in meeting client needs or because they were pig headed about insisting that every aspect of every booking condition be fulfilled.

Booking conditions may include reference to:

- How long the client has to sign the function contract (7 days is common). Often the contract includes a mention that the venue may sell the dates and times of the function to another party until the contract is signed and a deposit paid
- Need for the client to provide information by a set date that has not yet been provided but which is essential to the planning and preparation for the event
- Need for the client to advise the venue within a set time (48 hours) of any inaccuracies contained in the contract, running sheet etc.



- Ability of the client to make changes (up or down) to expected numbers to a given percentage (say 10%) up to 7 days before the function.

Where a decrease in numbers is notified according to this timeframe the conditions may indicate no penalty applies providing agreed 'minimum numbers' are attained.

Where an increase in numbers is notified a maximum number of extra people may be indicated as will the extra cost per person and there may be mention of the need to move to different rooms which may necessitate a higher room charge fee

- Payment. This can stipulate how payment is made, dates for payment and how payment can be made.

The conditions may state that, where the client requires a credit account with the venue, this must be formally applied for, and that all accounts are required to be paid on 'net 30 days' terms.

This section also explains that, where the venue produces an incorrect account (that is, one that is less than what it should be or one that omits a charge that should have been made), the venue retains the right to issue a supplementary account to recover these costs

- Cancellation policy. This applies where the total function has to be cancelled and sets out the percentage refund the client would be entitled to where a deposit has been made and the timing issues that apply (for example, X% refund if cancellation occurs before XX/XX/XX but a lesser percentage if the cancellation is received after that date).



Some venues may base their refund/cancellation statements on 'profit' – such as the venue will retain X% (say, 30%) of the quoted cost for food and beverage regarded as being the lost gross profit for the function.

Some venues may be prepared to refund the majority of the monies paid (say 90%) where they can re-sell the dates/rooms that have been cancelled

- Right of the venue to make changes. This gives the venue the right 'under extenuating circumstances' to alter any agreed part of the agreement provided they supply suitable alternative arrangements
- 'Force majeure'. Most contracts will contain a condition stating that in the event of 'force majeure' instances, which includes things such as riots, war, terrorism, natural disasters and fire the venue will not be held liable
- Right of the venue to refuse certain activities or individuals. While Equal Opportunity legislation must be observed, the venue will nearly always retain the right to prohibit certain people or activities on their premises.

Naturally this area is a sensitive one but the venue will often seek to protect its reputation, not to mention protect its physical assets and staff and other customers, by banning nominated activities. This means the venue will have, for example, the right to refuse to have a certain band play at the venue if it believes that band to be 'inappropriate'.



There is usually also some statement reminding the client that the venue has the right and legal obligation to remove anyone from the premises whose presence on the premises renders the venue liable to an offence under law

- Conditions that apply to decorating and using the venue. This will indicate the actions that the client can and cannot take when they are involved in preparing for the function. Common inclusions here are that the client cannot stick anything to walls, cannot nail anything in place or must ensure all items used are safe
- Loss and damage. This stipulates that the client must accept responsibility for any loss or damage they cause to the venue
- Check-in and check-out times for accommodation rooms that are being included as part of the function. This will also extend to bump-in, bump-out times.

Requesting the deposit

It is standard industry practice to request a deposit when the final details of a function have been confirmed.

Every venue has its own policy on the amount of deposit required to secure a function and this must be strictly adhered to. Due to the nature of the work, preparation and need to order stock such as food and beverages for a function, the deposit required is commonly substantial.

No function exists until a deposit has been paid.

You may have booked the required areas for an anticipated function, but it remains 'tentative' until a deposit has been secured and a contract signed.

In practical terms, this means a tentative function may be bumped where another client is prepared to pay a deposit and sign a contract for the same days.

Confirmation – and certainly the contract – may be in writing but, again, it is best to communicate this confirmation at a face to face meeting where ambiguities can be cleared up, explanations given and final changes made.

The face to face meeting allows you to pick up on any non-verbal cues that may indicate hesitance, reluctance or disagreement on the part of the client and address them as appropriate.

A personal meeting also sends the message you are taking this function seriously, and that it matters to you and the venue.

Whilst getting the details finalised are obviously important, it is equally important that you remain flexible about certain aspects of the function.

Naturally the date and time are fixed, and to an extent the numbers must likewise be guaranteed. A minimum number is usually required to be paid for, and numbers above a set figure are required to be paid for at \$X per head.

Dates for notifying final numbers are also immovable when they have been agreed to.

However, many other aspects of a function cannot be set in concrete, and by their nature must be 'set in jelly'.



Steps associated with handling deposits

Each organisation will be different in terms of the policies and procedures to be followed when handling deposit requests. That said common steps to follow include:

- Requesting deposit payment. This can be based on a standard establishment requirement such as percentage of estimated or quoted final cost
- Setting date for payment of deposit. This is important as it helps to determine the seriousness of the potential client and in addition allows a conference department to release a function room with adequate time to rebook it
- Advising of payment options. Many hospitality organisations will have established payment options including:
 - Charge back to company. This normally requires a credit check to be conducted and also some guaranteeing method of payment to be recorded
 - EFT (Electronic Funds Transfer). This is a common form of payment enabling money to be transferred electronically from the client's bank account into that of the hotel
 - Cash – not a common method but certainly a preferred option
 - Debit and credit cards. These may be processed, either as a pre-payment or a pre-authorisation. This can be conducted face to face when the client is at the establishment or done via email using appropriate procedures
- Issuing receipt for deposit. This normally accompanies the confirmation
- Recording payment of deposit on internal documentation – normally the functions department will obtain a record of the payment, either through the financial department or via front office, if the payment was made face to face.



It is essential that regardless of where and how the payment was received, that it is recorded on file, normally through the establishment of a house account dedicated to the function.

In addition, it is essential that the functions department is aware of when it is made, so that they can issue a receipt in a timely manner and to ensure they aren't following up a payment which already has been made

- Advising customer of amount outstanding – if there is any amount outstanding from the agreed deposit amount or for payments required for external suppliers, this must be followed up according to organisational policy.



Updated financial information

When the client pays a deposit for a function an account is usually opened for them at this stage.

- It is vital the first entry on this account shows their deposit and places their account in credit
- Make sure you check the details of any account that is prepared, verifying correct figures, names, addresses
- It may be company policy to mail the client a copy of this, or a receipt or both for monies received. A copy of all paperwork relating to payments received must also be placed in the function file so that anyone looking at the file knows immediately what the financial status of the file is
- As further payments are made by the client these too must be entered on to the account and updated in the function file. For example 'progress payments' may have been negotiated for large functions, where there is a relatively long lead-time and large expenses have been accumulated
- It is important the function file contains these details relating to account status as often the venue representative and the client will meet at times when the accounts department is closed and this information cannot be obtained, if needed
- Similarly, expenses are posted as appropriate reflecting purchases that have been made in relation to the function. These figures are essential for post-function administration and analysis.



Preparing confirmations

A standard pro forma confirmation is sent to the client when they have signed the function contract and paid a deposit.

This confirmation acknowledges the contract has been signed and that money has been paid and received.

In addition a copy of the Function Sheet is also sent which gives brief details about the basics of the function including type, dates, times, numbers, brief menu. This is explained in more detail in the next section.

Confirmations serve to give the client confidence the function has been secured and will go ahead.

Confirmations may also be sent by the venue to suppliers and third party providers once the function has been confirmed, advising what the venue requires them to provide for the function and letting them know it is going ahead.

Confirmation to the client should be in hard copy form whilst confirmation to suppliers can be email, fax or phone.

It is also important to ensure that the function is written as confirmed in the Functions Booking book.



Work Projects

It is a requirement of this Unit that you complete Work Projects as advised by your Trainer. You must submit documentation, suitable evidence or other relevant proof of completion of the project to your Trainer by the agreed date.

3.1 To fulfil the requirements of this Work Project you are asked to, based on the event in Work Project 1:

- Prepare a written proposal
- Prepare a Contract
- Explain how you would gain confirmation of an event from a client.

Summary

Prepare a concept plan

Document theme and operational context of the event or function

- Prepare proposal
- Follow up proposal.

Document elements of the total concept agreed to by customer/s and/or stakeholders

- Event management plan
- Function sheets
- Maintaining and updating Function Sheet.

Gain written agreement from customer/s and/or stakeholders

- The Event Contract
- Booking conditions
- Requesting the deposit
- Steps associated with handling deposits
- Updated financial information
- Preparing confirmations.

Presentation of written work

1. Introduction

It is important for students to present carefully prepared written work. Written presentation in industry must be professional in appearance and accurate in content. If students develop good writing skills whilst studying, they are able to easily transfer those skills to the workplace.

2. Style



Students should write in a style that is simple and concise. Short sentences and paragraphs are easier to read and understand. It helps to write a plan and at least one draft of the written work so that the final product will be well organised. The points presented will then follow a logical sequence and be relevant. Students should frequently refer to the question asked, to keep 'on track'. Teachers recognise and are critical of work that does not answer the question, or is 'padded' with irrelevant material. In summary, remember to:

- Plan ahead
- Be clear and concise
- Answer the question
- Proofread the final draft.

3. Presenting Written Work

Types of written work

Students may be asked to write:

- Short and long reports
- Essays
- Records of interviews
- Questionnaires
- Business letters
- Resumes.



Format

All written work should be presented on A4 paper, single-sided with a left-hand margin. If work is word-processed, one-and-a-half or double spacing should be used. Handwritten work must be legible and should also be well spaced to allow for ease of reading. New paragraphs should not be indented but should be separated by a space. Pages must be numbered. If headings are also to be numbered, students should use a logical and sequential system of numbering.

Cover Sheet

All written work should be submitted with a cover sheet stapled to the front that contains:

- The student's name and student number
- The name of the class/unit
- The due date of the work
- The title of the work
- The teacher's name
- A signed declaration that the work does not involve plagiarism.

Keeping a Copy

Students must keep a copy of the written work in case it is lost. This rarely happens but it can be disastrous if a copy has not been kept.

Inclusive language

This means language that includes every section of the population. For instance, if a student were to write 'A nurse is responsible for the patients in her care at all times' it would be implying that all nurses are female and would be excluding male nurses.

Examples of appropriate language are shown on the right:

Mankind	<i>Humankind</i>
Barman/maid	<i>Bar attendant</i>
Host/hostess	<i>Host</i>
Waiter/waitress	<i>Waiter or waiting staff</i>

Recommended reading

Allen, Judy; 2009 (2nd edition); *Event Planning: The Ultimate Guide to Successful Meetings, Corporate Events, Fundraising Galas, Conferences, Conventions, Incentives and Other Special Events*; Wiley

Arduser, Lora and Brown, Douglas R; 2004; *The Waiter & Waitress and Waitstaff Training Handbook: A Complete Guide to the Proper Steps in Service for Food & Beverage Employees*; Atlantic Publishing Group Inc.

Davidoff, Donald M; 1993; *Contact: Customer Service in the Hospitality and Tourism Industry*; Prentice Hall

Fenich, George; 2011 (3rd edition); *Meetings, Expositions, Events & Conventions: An Introduction to the Industry*; Prentice Hall

Ford, Robert; 1999; *Managing the Guest Experience in Hospitality*; Delmar Cengage Learning

Golden-Romero, Pat; 2007; *Hotel Convention Sales, Services, and Operations*; Butterworth-Heinemann

Johnston, R & Clark G, 2008 (3rd Edition); *Service Operations Management*; Pearson Education

Lillicrap, Dennis & Cousins, John; 2010; *Essential Food and Beverage Service: Levels 1 & 2*; Hodder Arnold

Martin, William B; 2001; *Quality Service: What Every Hospitality Manager Needs to Know*; Prentice Hall

Scock, Patti; 2006; *On-Premise Catering: Hotels, Convention & Conference Centers and Clubs*; Wiley

Zeithaml, Valarie A; 2009; *Delivering Quality Service*; Free Press

Trainee evaluation sheet

Design a concept for a major event or function

The following statements are about the competency you have just completed.

Please tick the appropriate box	Agree	Don't Know	Do Not Agree	Does Not Apply
There was too much in this competency to cover without rushing.	☐	☐	☐	☐
Most of the competency seemed relevant to me.	☐	☐	☐	☐
The competency was at the right level for me.	☐	☐	☐	☐
I got enough help from my trainer.	☐	☐	☐	☐
The amount of activities was sufficient.	☐	☐	☐	☐
The competency allowed me to use my own initiative.	☐	☐	☐	☐
My training was well-organised.	☐	☐	☐	☐
My trainer had time to answer my questions.	☐	☐	☐	☐
I understood how I was going to be assessed.	☐	☐	☐	☐
I was given enough time to practice.	☐	☐	☐	☐
My trainer feedback was useful.	☐	☐	☐	☐
Enough equipment was available and it worked well.	☐	☐	☐	☐
The activities were too hard for me.	☐	☐	☐	☐

The best things about this unit were:

The worst things about this unit were:

The things you should change in this unit are:



Trainee Self-Assessment Checklist

As an indicator to your Trainer/Assessor of your readiness for assessment in this unit please complete the following and hand to your Trainer/Assessor.

Design a concept for a major event or function

		Yes	No*
Element 1: Identify key objectives of event			
1.1	Clarify key objectives of event in consultation with customer/s and/or key stakeholders	☐	☐
1.2	Identify and analyse key information in consultation with customer/s and/or key stakeholders and other relevant parties	☐	☐
1.3	Identify and analyse factors which might impact on the event	☐	☐
Element 2: Establish concept, theme and format of event			
2.1	Meet both customer needs and expectations in accordance with organisation standards, policies and procedures and within acceptable time frames	☐	☐
2.2	Develop an overall event concept, theme and format which reflects key objectives agreed upon with customer/s and/or key stakeholders	☐	☐
2.3	Verify practicality and viability of concept, theme and format through a sound process of consultation and analysis	☐	☐
2.4	Identify logistical requirements of overall concept, theme and format	☐	☐
2.5	Obtain relevant approval from customer/s and/or stakeholders prior to implementation	☐	☐
Element 3: Prepare a concept plan			
3.1	Document theme and operational context of the event or function	☐	☐
3.2	Document elements of the total concept agreed to by customer/s and/or stakeholders	☐	☐
3.3	Gain written agreement from customer/s and/or stakeholders	☐	☐

Statement by Trainee:

I believe I am ready to be assessed on the following as indicated above:

Signed: _____ **Date:** _____ / _____ / _____

Note:

For all boxes where a **No*** is ticked, please provide details of the extra steps or work you need to do to become ready for assessment.

